TOPIC REPORTS: CONNECTIVITY

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CONNECTIVITY · DATA STORAGE · ENERGY · TECHNICAL CAPACITY · CYBERSECURITY

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Algeria

CITIES IN THE GLOBAL MOBILE-SPEED RANKING

- **سرعة إنترنت الهاتف النقال: مدينة جزائرية جديدة في قائمة الـ 50 الأفضل عالميا** — Echorouk El Yawmi, 6 September 2026

  Oran entered Ookla's monthly global top 50 of cities by mobile internet speed for the first time, at 41st with 197.09 Mbps, joining Algiers at 42nd, reported on 6 September 2026. Algeria's telecoms ministry said national average mobile download speed rose from 40.86 Mbps in July 2025 to 78.36 Mbps in July 2026, and fixed from 50.85 to 90.45 Mbps.

PROGRAMME TO END OUT-OF-NETWORK ZONES

- **Sans fritures** — El Moudjahid, 7 September 2026

  An editorial in Algeria's El Moudjahid on 7 September 2026 states that areas without telecoms coverage are to be connected within 18 months, in an operation covering about 3,000 remote rural zones and funded entirely from the state budget. It gives no operator, cost or start date.

ALGIERS IN THE GLOBAL GIGABIT-CITY INDEX

- **Gigacity 2026 : Alger, première ville africaine du très haut débit** — La Sentinelle, 1 October 2026

  Algeria's Ministry of Post and Telecommunications said on 30 September 2026 that Algiers ranked first in Africa and 34th of 50 cities worldwide in Omdia's Gigacity Index 2026, with 36 points, 11 places ahead of Cape Town. The ministry cited fibre-to-the-home coverage of nearly 100% in the capital and 90% of subscribers on speeds above 100 Mbps.

"ALL FIBER" NATIONAL FIBRE PROGRAMME (COPPER PHASE-OUT)

- **Algérie : la fibre optique dépasse 4 millions d'abonnements, les tarifs chutent de 76 %** — Agence Ecofin, 12 October 2026

  Algeria's fibre-to-the-home subscriptions passed 4 million in early October, from 53,000 in June 2020, on the posts minister's figures. The monthly price of an offer of 100 Mbit/s or more has fallen 76%, and the target is more than 4.4 million by the end of the year.

Angola

DOMESTIC SUBMARINE CABLE

- **Governo pretende estender fibra óptica a todo o país** — ANGOP, 2 September 2026

  Angola's telecommunications minister Mário Oliveira said on 2 September 2026 in Lobito that the government is preparing a domestic submarine cable linking the networks of coastal cities, as part of extending fibre-optic services nationwide. He spoke at the launch of ZAP Fibra in Benguela province and said links to neighbouring countries and an earth-observation satellite are also planned. No cost or timetable is given.

OPERATOR FIBRE NETWORK IN BENGUELA

- **Ministro Mário Oliveira inaugura ZAP Fibra em Benguela** — Angop - Agência Angola Press, 2 September 2026

  Angola's telecommunications ministry inaugurated an operator's fibre network in Benguela province, the operator having installed a data centre at Lobito as the platform behind its internet and television services along the coastline. The minister named nationwide fibre coverage as the objective and said a submarine cable landing at Benguela is being prepared.

BENGUELA BACKBONE LINK WITH A PRIVATE OPERATOR

- **Mário Oliveira testemunha lançamento do primeiro link de banda larga na Restinga** — PTI (Portal das Tecnologias de Informação, Angola), 15 September 2026

  Angola's telecommunications minister, Mário Oliveira, was due in Benguela province on 16 September 2026 to launch Angola Telecom's TudoNossoFibra internet service at Baía Farta and the first Angola Telecom and MSTelcom broadband link in Restinga, Lobito. He was also to hand over a primary school rehabilitated under the Ngola Digital project.

- **Mercury e Angola Telecom reforçam conectividade em Bengula com novo link de Banda Larga** — Poc Notícias (Angola), 16 September 2026

  Mercury and Angola Telecom brought into service a new broadband backbone link at Restinga, Lobito, in Benguela province on 16 September 2026, under Angola's National Broadband Programme. The first phase provides 100 Gbps of capacity, and the operators describe it as the first of several provincial backbone links. No cost is given.

- **ANGOLA TELECOM e MERCURY reforçam conectividade com ligação banda larga em BENGUELA** — Revista Executivo (Angola), 18 September 2026

  Angola Telecom and Mercury marked the start of a new broadband backbone link at Restinga, Lobito, in Benguela province, during a visit by telecoms minister Mário Oliveira, reported on 18 September 2026. The link is part of the National Broadband Programme, with 100 Gbps of capacity in its first phase, and is the first of several planned provincial backbone links.

NATIONAL RADIO TRANSMITTER EXPANSION AND MODERNISATION (PEMIX)

- **Ministro destaca processo de modernização da RNA** — Angop (Angola Press Agency), 15 September 2026

  Angola's telecoms minister, Mário Oliveira, said on 15 September 2026, at the launch of a podcast by Rádio Nacional de Angola, that the station's modernisation will improve signal and extend coverage in phases. He put Angola's mobile subscribers at about 29 million and mobile internet users at 18.7 to 19 million, and said Angola Online has about 183 free access points.

- **RNA ganha centro de monitorização de emissores** — Angop (Angola Press Agency), 15 September 2026

Angola's telecommunications minister, Mário Oliveira, inaugurated a centre in Luanda on 15 September 2026 that monitors Rádio Nacional de Angola's national transmitter network in real time, and the station switched from analogue to digital at the same event. He said this completes the Luanda phase of the station's modernisation project, with Namibe and Huíla next.

NATIONAL BROADBAND NETWORK

- **Ministro Mário Oliveira lança serviço de internet 'Tudonosso' na Baía Farta** — Angop (Angola Press Agency), 16 September 2026

  Angola Telecom switched on its Tudonosso fibre-to-the-home service at the 1,000-dwelling Baía Farta housing centre in Benguela on 16 September 2026, the first site of a project the telecoms minister placed within the national broadband network.

- **Rede de banda larga de fibra óptica já funciona em Benguela** — Angop (Angola Press Agency), 16 September 2026

  Angola inaugurated the first link of its national fibre broadband network at Lobito on 16 September 2026, on a route from Luanda through Bengo and Cuanza Sul. Angola Telecom named Huambo, Namibe and Cabinda for the next phase, with all 21 provinces as the aim.

- **Fibra óptica de 400 Gb chega ao Lobito e "Tudo Nosso" da Angola Telecom avança na Baía Farta** — PTI — Portal de Tecnologias de Informação, 21 September 2026

  Angola Telecom launched its Tudo Nosso fibre network at the Baía Farta housing development in Benguela province, and the national fibre trunk of about 400 Gb was completed to Lobito, PTI reported on 21 September 2026. Telecoms minister Mário Oliveira also opened a free Angola Online internet point at a primary school there. No cost is given.

UNITEL SUBSCRIBERS AND NETWORK FOOTPRINT

- **UNITEL Revenue Rises 17% to 274 Billion Kwanzas in H1 2026 as Data Use Surges** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  Angolan operator UNITEL reported first-half 2026 revenue of 274 billion kwanzas, up 17%, with EBITDA of 91 billion kwanzas and net income of 66.3 billion. Subscribers passed 21.2 million, data use rose 43% and the network reached 12,302 base stations.

PROJECTO CONECTA

- **GGPEN, ANYCONNECT partner to bolster Conecta Angola connectivity through 2Africa** — Tech Review Africa, 29 September 2026

  Traffic from Conecta Angola's satellite terminals is now routed from its hub onto the 2Africa cable through UNITEL's landing station at Cacuaco, to add capacity and a second international route. No capacity figure was given.

SACS AND MONET SUBMARINE CABLE SYSTEMS

- **Angola Cables Boosts Capacity Across MONET and SACS Submarine Cable Systems with Ciena Technology** — Ciena, 29 September 2026

  Angola Cables is deploying Ciena's WaveLogic 6 Extreme optical equipment and network software across its MONET and SACS submarine cables, Ciena announced on 29 September 2026. The upgrade adds 800G services on a 12,780 km route linking the United States, Brazil and Angola, with 130 ms round-trip delay, for cloud and AI traffic. No cost is given.

TWOOBII ONEWEB POINT OF PRESENCE, LUANDA

- **Q-KON, SISTEC launch sovereign satellite service for Angola** — CAJ News Africa, 14 October 2026

  Q-KON and SISTEC opened a point of presence in Luanda for the Twoobii OneWeb low-Earth-orbit satellite service, hosted at SISTEC's premises. It gives in-country data breakout with local IP addresses alongside Eutelsat OneWeb's Angolan gateway, and is sold to banks, government, defence and enterprises.

Botswana

BOFINET INTERNATIONAL CAPACITY LEASE THROUGH SOUTH AFRICA

- **BoFiNet upgrades its available international capacity to 1 Tbit/s** — Connecting Africa, 23 September 2026

  Botswana Fibre Networks signed a long-term international capacity lease with an unnamed South African partner, raising capacity through the Ramatlabama and Pioneer Gate border crossings from 300 Gbit/s to 1 Tbit/s.

DIGITAL DELTA IX

- **BoFiNet launches Digital Delta IXP** — ITWeb Africa, 6 October 2026

  Botswana's state fibre operator BoFiNet announced the launch of the Digital Delta Internet Exchange Point, where service providers, mobile operators and content and cloud providers can exchange local traffic inside the country. It builds on the operator's Tier III-certified data centre.

UNIVERSAL FUND BROADBAND EXPANSION ALONG THE TRANS-KALAHARI HIGHWAY

- **Botswana invests in highway connectivity** — ITWeb Africa, 12 October 2026

  Botswana's universal service fund, working with one mobile operator, has deployed 12 mobile broadband and voice sites along the 1,900km Trans-Kalahari Highway at a cost of P34.5 million, the communications minister said. Infrastructure sharing with the other two operators is to extend coverage by the end of the next financial year.

Burkina Faso

800-TOWER WHITE-ZONE CONNECTIVITY PLAN

- **Télécommunications : 750 villages burkinabè sortiront bientôt des zones blanches** — Reflet Info, 9 October 2026

  Burkina Faso's digital transition minister, Aminata Zerbo, said on 8 October 2026 that 750 villages without network coverage will get calls, internet and mobile money by the end of 2026, and 750 more by 2028, with 25 billion FCFA mobilised by the state. She said 3,140 government buildings are now connected and the administration's bandwidth has risen from 9 to 20 Gbps.

Burundi

INTERNATIONAL CAPACITY THROUGH NEIGHBOURING LANDINGS

- **TTCL and BBS Increase Tanzania-Burundi Connectivity Capacity from 4Gbps to 10Gbps** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026 TANZANIA

  Tanzania's state operator agreed with Burundi Backbone System to raise cross-border capacity from 4Gbps to 10Gbps through the National ICT Broadband Backbone, framed as a response to demand for cross-border digital services and enterprise connectivity.

Cameroon

TRANSIT ROLE FOR A LANDLOCKED NEIGHBOUR'S CABLE CAPACITY

- **Accès aux câbles sous-marins : quelles options pour la Centrafrique au-delà du Cameroun** — Camerounlink (source: Agence Ecofin), 1 September 2026 CAR

  A fibre cut in Cameroon disrupted internet service in the Central African Republic last week, prompting an assessment of the landlocked country's options for reaching submarine cable capacity by another route.

STATE OPERATOR FIBRE CONNECTIVITY FOR SCHOOLS

- **Camtel Expands Fibre Connectivity to Schools Across Cameroon** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026

  Cameroon's state telecommunications operator is extending fibre connectivity to schools, covering communities from the northern to the southern and the eastern to the western regions. It presents the programme as digital inclusion in education, aimed at improving school internet access and pupils' reach to digital educational resources.

CAMTEL MOBILE NETWORK EXPANSION PROJECT

- **Camtel Plans 245 New Mobile Sites to Narrow Network Gap With Rivals** — Business in Cameroon, 18 September 2026

  Cameroon's state operator plans 245 new mobile sites, taking its declared network from 473 to 718, with decongestion of 122 existing sites and a new billing system; a second shipment of equipment from China arrived on 17 September. No cost or completion date is stated.

E-NATIONAL HIGHER EDUCATION NETWORK

- **Coopération universitaire : le MINESUP et China Exim Bank évaluent le projet ENHEN** — C24 Infos, 25 September 2026

  Cameroon's higher education minister, Jacques Fame Ndongo, and a China Exim Bank delegation led by Wang Chunying reviewed the E-National Higher Education Network project in Yaoundé on 24 September 2026. The ministry listed its outputs as 500,000 computers for students, ten university digital centres, campus interconnection and e-learning and administrative applications. No usage figures or new financing were given.

CAB-CORRIDOR TERRESTRIAL INTERCONNECTION (CAMEROON, GABON, CONGO)

- **CAB-CORRIDOR : la SPIN et CAMTEL renforcent la connectivité numérique en Afrique centrale - Société de Patrimoine des Infrastructures Numériques CAB-CORRIDOR : SPIN et CAMTEL renforcent la connectivité en Afrique centrale** — SPIN Gabon, 3 October 2026 GABON

  Gabon's digital infrastructure holding SPIN and Cameroon's operator CAMTEL have signed a memorandum of understanding and a confidentiality agreement on CAB-CORRIDOR, a terrestrial link between Cameroon, Gabon and the Republic of Congo over the Central African Backbone, SPIN said on 3 October 2026. Implementation terms are expected in October 2026; signing dates are not given.

CAMTEL AND SECONDARY-EDUCATION MINISTRY SCHOOL INTERCONNECTION AGREEMENT

- **CAMTEL and MINESEC Sign Deal to Expand Digital Education Across Northern Cameroon** — Tech Africa News, 8 October 2026

  CAMTEL and Cameroon's secondary education ministry signed a framework agreement to interconnect 130 schools in the Adamawa, North and Far North regions. No amount was stated.

CAMTEL-SIC FIBRE AGREEMENT FOR PUBLIC HOUSING

- **CAMTEL Partners with SIC to Expand Fibre Connectivity Across Cameroon Housing Estates** — Tech Africa News, 8 October 2026

  CAMTEL signed a framework agreement with Cameroon's state housing company to bring fibre to its existing estates and build it into new ones. Residents are offered a connection at FCFA 25,000 and FCFA 15,000 a month.

- **Cameroon's CAMTEL, SIC Sign Agreement to Bring Fibre Internet to Public Housing - Business in Cameroon** — Business in Cameroon, 14 October 2026

  CAMTEL and the state housing developer SIC signed a framework agreement in Yaoundé to connect SIC estates to fibre, starting with about 40 households out of more than 30,000 SIC clients. Subscriptions start at CFAF 15,000 a month with CFAF 25,000 installation, and new SIC buildings are to be prewired.

CAMTEL AND SOCADEL INFRASTRUCTURE SHARING

- **Camtel, Socadel explore infrastructure sharing deal** — ITWeb Africa, 19 October 2026

  Cameroon's Camtel and electricity utility Socadel signed a memorandum of understanding in Yaoundé on 16 October 2026 to study infrastructure sharing. It would pair Camtel's national fibre backbone with Socadel's poles and rights-of-way to extend fibre along overhead power lines. Feasibility studies and pilot sites come next.

Cape Verde

SOUTH ATLANTIC INTERCONNECTION CORRIDOR (DE-CIX AND CVTELECOM)

- **DE-CIX and Cabo Verde Telecom Plan New South Atlantic Interconnection Corridor** — DE-CIX, 29 September 2026

  DE-CIX and Cabo Verde Telecom signed a non-binding letter of intent to explore a Lisbon to Sao Paulo interconnection corridor, the operator supplying transport capacity in return for access to DE-CIX exchanges. Terms await a definitive agreement.

Central African Republic

ROUTES TO SUBMARINE CABLE CAPACITY BEYOND THE CURRENT TRANSIT COUNTRY

- **Accès aux câbles sous-marins : quelles options pour la Centrafrique au-delà du Cameroun** — Camerounlink (source: Agence Ecofin), 1 September 2026 CAMEROON

  A fibre cut in Cameroon disrupted internet service in the Central African Republic last week, prompting an assessment of the landlocked country's options for reaching submarine cable capacity by another route.

- **Internet : qu'est-ce que la liaison par fibre avec la RDC peut apporter à la Centrafrique** — Agence Ecofin, 12 October 2026 DRC

  The digital-economy ministers of the Central African Republic and DR Congo agreed in Moscow on 8 October on the need to carry out a fibre interconnection between the two countries, which would give the Central African Republic a third international route, toward the submarine cable landing at Moanda. No timetable or financing was announced.

Chad

FIBRE KILOMETRES LAID AND MASTS ERECTED UNDER THE CONNECTIVITY PROGRAMME

- **Infrastructure numérique : le Tchad a encore besoin de 8000 km de fibre optique** — Agence Ecofin, 17 September 2026

Chad's telecommunications minister, Haliki Choua Mahamat, told the World Bank's resident representative on 15 September 2026 that Chad still needs about 8,000 km of optical fibre to cover its territory, with six provinces not yet connected. The ITU estimates that about 87% of Chadians did not use the internet in 2024, and 4G covered 60% of the population.

- **Tchad : le ministre des Télécommunications échange avec les partenaires européens sur la transformation numérique** — tachad.com, 9 October 2026

  Chad's digital minister Haliki Choua Mahamat told German, EU and GIZ representatives on 9 October 2026 that the country has about 6,000 km of optical fibre and aims for 14,000 km, citing the Trans-Saharan backbone and links with Libya and Nigeria. He also named a World Bank-funded project for uncovered areas and a national data centre, and said a digital code is still being drafted.

Congo

UNIVERSAL ACCESS AND SERVICE FUND

- **Le Congo et l'Afrique centrale s'organisent pour mieux résister aux catastrophes** — La Brève Online, 15 September 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  Experts from eight Central African countries met in Brazzaville on 15–17 September 2026 to review a model national emergency telecommunications plan for keeping communications running in disasters. Figures presented there credit Congo's universal service fund FASUCE with connecting more than 380,000 people in isolated areas and over 250 localities.

Cote d'Ivoire

THIRD-PARTY DAMAGE TO TELECOMMUNICATIONS CABLES

- **Orange Côte d'Ivoire Warns of Legal Action After Telecom Cables Damaged in Cocody** — TechAfrica News, 4 September 2026

  Orange Cote d'Ivoire warned it may take legal action after construction works severed several of its telecommunications cables in an Abidjan district on 2 September, disrupting fixed, mobile and internet services for more than 1,121 customers. The operator named the construction company responsible, cited repeated damage to its fibre and called on construction firms to coordinate better when working near telecommunications infrastructure.

5G COMMERCIAL LAUNCH

- **AIP/ Transition numérique en Côte d'Ivoire : le gouvernement adopte un décret clé pour encadrer la libération des fréquences de la 5G** — Agence Ivoirienne de Presse (AIP), 14 October 2026

  Côte d'Ivoire's Council of Ministers adopted a decree on 14 October 2026 setting the financial terms for clearing the 3300-3600 MHz band for 5G, including state compensation for current holders of 3.5 GHz assignments. It also fixes the band factor used to calculate frequency fees. The decree's number and text were not published.

Djibouti

HORIZON TERRESTRIAL FIBRE CORRIDOR

- **Projet de fibre optique « Horizon » : Une nouvelle autoroute numérique pour la Corne de l'Afrique** — La Nation, 9 September 2026 ETHIOPIA SUDAN

> Djibouti Telecom, Ethio telecom and Sudatel presented their Horizon terrestrial fibre project to Google, Meta, Microsoft, Amazon and other carriers and vendors in Addis Ababa on 7 September 2026. The multi-terabit link would connect cable landing stations in Djibouti and Port Sudan through Ethiopia, reducing reliance on Red Sea submarine cables. No cost or launch date is given.

DR Congo

> INDEPENDENT TOWER ESTATE

- **RDC : plus de 40 millions de Congolais connectés grâce aux infrastructures de Helios Towers** — ACTUALITE.CD, 4 September 2026

  Helios Towers RDC said on 3 September 2026 that it now operates 3,000 telecoms sites in the Democratic Republic of Congo, 673 of them in rural areas, and that its infrastructure supports mobile coverage for more than 40 million people. The milestone marks the company's fifteenth year in the country. The figures come from a company release carried by the paper.

> KIGOMA-KALEMIE FIBRE ACROSS LAKE TANGANYIKA

- **Tanzania, DRC agree to fast-track SGR link and fibre-optic cable across Lake Tanganyika** — Daily News (Tanzania), 5 September 2026 TANZANIA

  Tanzania and the DRC agreed to fast-track a fibre-optic cable from Kigoma to Kalemie across Lake Tanganyika, alongside a standard gauge railway link through Burundi and the establishment of a joint economic commission. The commitment was reaffirmed at a farewell meeting for the Congolese ambassador; no route survey, cost, financing or delivery date is published.

> GOMA-MOMBASA FIBRE ROUTE

- **Paratus expands East Africa connectivity ahead of ITW Africa** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026 RWANDA UGANDA KENYA

  Paratus said its 2,000km Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial fibre route is live and carrying traffic, announced at the ITW and Datacloud Africa conference in Nairobi. The route links eastern DRC to the Kenyan coast through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi, with access to subsea capacity landing at Mombasa. Starlink services have launched in Uganda alongside it, and the company is introducing a Layer 2 connectivity service over low-earth-orbit satellite for the East African market.

> INTERNET SERVICE QUALITY IN KINSHASA AND THE REGULATOR'S RESPONSE

- **Connexion Internet à Kinshasa : les consommateurs à bout, les opérateurs interpellés, l'ARPTC sous pression** — Forum des As, 17 September 2026

  Internet subscribers in Kinshasa report slow speeds, frequent interruptions and difficulty reaching online services across all four mobile operators, against the packages they pay for. The regulator is being called on to act.

> NATIONAL DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION PROJECT FIBRE BACKBONE

- **DR Congo plans four 20-year PPPs for 11,600km fibre network** — The PPP Post, 26 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo plans to extend its fibre-optic backbone by 11,600 km through four 20-year concessions tendered internationally, with gap financing for routes whose revenues cannot cover the cost, reported on 26 September 2026. Expressions of interest for the supervision consultancy close on 14 October 2026, for work from June 2027.

HELIOS TOWERS AND UNICEF SCHOOL-CONNECTIVITY PARTNERSHIP (GIGA)

- **Helios Towers partners with UNICEF to accelerate digital inclusion and expand learning opportunities for children across Africa** — UNICEF UK, 28 September 2026 MALAWI TANZANIA

  Helios Towers and UNICEF announced a multi-year partnership on 28 September 2026 supporting UNICEF's Giga school-connectivity initiative and its Learning Passport digital-learning programme, starting in the Democratic Republic of Congo, Malawi and Tanzania. Helios Towers will support school connectivity mapping and infrastructure. No funding figure is given.

5G COMMERCIAL LAUNCH

- **RDC : le gouvernement annonce le lancement commercial de la 5G** — 7sur7.cd, 11 October 2026

  DR Congo's posts and telecommunications minister presented the commercial launch of 5G to the Council of Ministers on 9 October, as a new source of state revenue and a way to improve service quality. Deployment is to begin in urban areas; no operator, spectrum assignment or launch date was given.

- **RDC : la 5G en préparation, près de 7 Congolais sur 10 restent hors ligne** — wearetech.africa, 12 October 2026

  DR Congo's government is preparing a commercial 5G launch, which the telecommunications minister said in late September it was working to make available before the end of 2026. The article sets that against internet use of about 30.5% of the population at the end of 2025 and mobile internet coverage of 45%.

FIBRE INTERCONNECTION WITH THE CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC

- **Internet : qu'est-ce que la liaison par fibre avec la RDC peut apporter à la Centrafrique** — Agence Ecofin, 12 October 2026 CAR

  The digital-economy ministers of the Central African Republic and DR Congo agreed in Moscow on 8 October on the need to carry out a fibre interconnection between the two countries, which would give the Central African Republic a third international route, toward the submarine cable landing at Moanda. No timetable or financing was announced.

TELECOMMUNICATIONS CUT IN FIZI TERRITORY AND BARAKA, SOUTH KIVU

- **Sud-Kivu : la société civile exige la réouverture des réseaux de télécommunications coupés depuis 3 mois** — CongoRassure, 13 October 2026

  Civil society in Fizi territory and Baraka, South Kivu, published a memorandum to the President demanding the reopening of telecommunications networks it says have been cut since 3 July 2026. It alleges that soldiers seized satellite kits and phones and that local authorities resold satellite Wi-Fi, and announces a sit-in from 19 October.

Egypt

SHARM EL SHEIKH-TABA SUBSEA CABLE

- **Telecom Egypt to Advance Egypt's Eastern Digital Corridor with a Multiple-Petabit Sharm El Sheikh-Taba Subsea Cable in Accordance with its New Strategy** — Telecom Egypt Investor Relations, 3 September 2026

  Telecom Egypt signed an agreement to build a multiple-petabit subsea cable between Sharm El Sheikh and Taba, which it frames as extending the country's eastern digital corridor.

- **Internet : l'Egypte renforce ses capacites regionales avec un nouveau cable sous-marin** — Agence Ecofin, 4 September 2026

Egypt plans a roughly 200 km subsea cable from Sharm El Sheikh on the Red Sea to Taba on the Gulf of Aqaba, carried by Telecom Egypt with the Greek company Power Sub Link, adding high-capacity domestic routing options. The account notes the country already has the continent's largest concentration of submarine cables, about twenty connected with five more under construction.

- **Telecom Egypt to extend Red2Med system to Taba with petabit link** — Developing Telecoms, 4 September 2026

  Telecom Egypt signed an agreement with the Greek contractor Power Sub Link to build a 200 km repeaterless subsea cable from Sharm El Sheikh to Taba up the Gulf of Aqaba coast, designed for 5 Pbps. It will interconnect with the Red Sea festoon system that forms the southern half of the Red2Med route to Port Said. No cost or in-service date is stated.

- **Telecom Egypt's 5Pbps Red Sea bypass puts chokepoint resilience back in the spotlight** — Capacity, 7 September 2026

  Telecom Egypt named the contractor for a 200km subsea cable between Sharm El Sheikh and Taba, extending its Red Sea festoon into a continuous Suez-to-Taba route designed for about 5 petabits per second.

EGYPT'S INTERNET EXCHANGE POINTS

- **EG-IX: Egypt peaks near 1 Tbps on 18 member networks** — tech.africa, 8 September 2026

  Egypt's main internet exchange EG-IX peaked at 722.19Gb/s over the preceding day across 18 member networks holding about 3Tbps of provisioned ports over 31 connections, every one running IPv6. Only five members are Egyptian; the exchange is owned by the state-controlled incumbent and run on a vendor platform, where most large African exchanges are member-owned or neutrally run.

VODAFONE EGYPT RADIO-ACCESS NETWORK MODERNISATION WITH AI-CAPABLE PROCESSORS

- **Ericsson Modernizes Vodafone Egypt's RAN with AI-Powered RAN Processor 6672** — Africa Telecom Review, 21 September 2026

  Vodafone Egypt has started commercial rollout of Ericsson's AI-capable RAN Processor 6672, making Egypt one of the first markets after Japan. The unit runs AI at each radio site rather than centrally, and Ericsson claims it gives up to four times the processing capacity for less than half the energy. No number of sites, contract value or timetable was given.

Equatorial Guinea

STARLINK SERVICE AND ITS CENTRALISED DISTRIBUTION

- **Guinée équatoriale / Internet satellitaire : Starlink officiellement lancé** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 9 September 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's vice-president, Teodoro Nguema Obiang Mangue, announced on 9 September 2026 the official launch of SpaceX's Starlink satellite internet service. Sales will be centralised, requests handled by the telecoms regulator Ortel, and earlier connections made with foreign details deactivated. The government also plans talks with Meta on charging fees for use of its applications in the country.

BLOCK ON FACEBOOK AND TIKTOK WITH THROTTLED BANDWIDTH

- **Guinée équatoriale : coupure de Facebook et TikTok** — Seneweb, 16 September 2026

Facebook and TikTok have been unreachable in Equatorial Guinea without a VPN since 2 September 2026, with internet speeds throttled, AFP reports. The restrictions followed a viral video accusing Vice-President Teodoro Nguema Obiang of corruption; its author was arrested.

GETESA NETWORK MODERNISATION

- **GETESA ahorrará 262 millones de francos CFA al mes para reinvertirlos en la mejora de la red nacional** — AhoraEG, 8 October 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's Vice-President Teodoro Nguema Obiang Mangue told the finance ministry on 7 October 2026 to investigate and urgently release financing for state operator GETESA's network expansion agreement with Huawei, which Treasury payment arrears have slowed. GETESA will cancel non-essential maintenance contracts until December, saving over 262 million CFA francs a month for reinvestment in the network.

Ethiopia

NEXT HORIZON: DIGITAL & BEYOND 2028 STRATEGY

- **Ethio Telecom Announces Successful Completion of First Year of Next Horizon Strategy** — Ethiopian News Agency (ENA), 3 September 2026

  Ethio Telecom's chief executive, Frehiwot Tamiru, said on 3 September 2026 that the first year of its three-year Next Horizon strategy left about 90 million customers and close to 61 million telebirr users. Second-year targets include 96.2 million customers and 4G population coverage of 95%, up from 82.23%.

- **Ethio telecom Next Horizon - Digital & Beyond Strategy 2028 Year II 2019 EFY (2026/27) Annual Business Plan** — Ethio telecom, 3 September 2026

  Ethio telecom published the Year II business plan of its Next Horizon 2028 strategy on 3 September 2026, targeting ETB 295 billion in revenue for 2026/27, ETB 77.45 billion of it from digital businesses. It plans 96.2 million customers, 67.69 million telebirr users, 4G on 11,014 sites, 5G in 73 towns and 268 AI servers.

- **Ethio Telecom to Expand 4G Network to 11,014 Sites in 2026/27** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026

  Ethio Telecom is to expand its 4G network from 6,924 to 11,014 sites in 2026/27 under the Year II plan of its Next Horizon strategy. It is a published target, not an outturn.

ETHIO TELECOM NETWORK

- **Ethio Telecom Targets 96.2 Million Customers, ETB 295 Billion Revenue in 2026/27** — TechAfrica News, 4 September 2026

  Ethio Telecom set 2026/27 targets of 96.2 million customers and ETB 295 billion revenue in its annual business plan, the second year of its Next Horizon strategy. The plan raises 4G capacity from 22.79 million to 35.31 million subscribers and 4G population coverage from 82.23% to 95%, 5G sites from 340 to 648 and 5G towns from 33 to 73, backbone fibre from 23,442 km to 25,642 km and gateway capacity from 4.3 Tbps to 5.2 Tbps, with telebirr targeted at 67.69 million customers.

SAFARICOM ETHIOPIA SECOND NETWORK

- **Safaricom Ethiopia Surpasses 15 Million Subscribers After Four Years of Operations** — TechAfrica News, 4 September 2026

Safaricom Ethiopia passed 15 million 90-day active subscribers in under four years of commercial operation, marking five years since its unified licence of 9 July 2021. It has deployed more than 3,500 network sites, all 4G-enabled and 5G-ready, reaching about 60% of the population, and says the growing base is moving the business towards breakeven; it puts community investment at ETB 684 million over four years.

- **Safaricom Ethiopia Engages Government on Network Expansion and Digital Transformation** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026

  Safaricom Ethiopia put itself at 15 million 90-day active customers and more than 3,600 sites in five years of operation, at a meeting with the innovation and technology minister. Its chief executive raised infrastructure and supply-chain constraints on further rollout, including the timely customs clearance of telecommunications equipment and fibre cable.

- **Safaricom Ethiopia passes 15 million subscribers five years after getting its licence** — Tech-ish, 14 September 2026

  Safaricom Ethiopia announced on 3 September 2026 that it has passed 15 million 90-day active subscribers, five years after receiving its licence in July 2021. It had 14.7 million on 30 June 2026. The company reports more than 3,500 network sites covering about 60% of the population; no exact subscriber figure was given.

Gabon

GABIX (GABON INTERNET EXCHANGE POINT)

- **IXP Tracker - Gabon | ISOC Pulse** — Internet Society Pulse, 1 September 2026

  The Internet Society's Pulse tracker lists one active internet exchange point in Gabon as of September 2026, with eight members, drawing on PeeringDB data. The country has nine active networks and an internet resilience score of 52 out of 100, with international connections rated fair.

NATIONAL BACKBONE PUBLIC-PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP (SPIN AND GABON FIBER)

- **Gabon Advances National Backbone Project With 3,420km Network Plan** — Tech Africa News, 11 September 2026

  Gabon held workshops in Libreville on 9–10 September 2026 to review a draft public-private partnership between the state digital-infrastructure company SPIN and Gabon Fiber to run and extend the national fibre backbone. The project covers about 3,420km: 1,769km existing and 1,651km planned. Signature was scheduled for 14 September 2026.

NATIONAL BACKBONE CONCESSION

- **Gabon/Numérique : Gabon Fiber S.A. ambitionne de mobiliser plus de 41 milliards FCFA pour construire 1 650 km de fibre optique** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 14 September 2026

  Gabon Fiber S.A., a private Gabonese company, said on 14 September 2026 that it will seek more than FCFA 41 billion on international financial markets to build 1,650 km of optical fibre to towns including Lambaréné, Makokou, Mouila and Tchibanga. Its director general spoke at the signing of concessions with the state infrastructure holding company SPIN.

- **Gabon/Numérique : signature d'un partenariat entre la SPIN et Gabon Fiber S.A.** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 14 September 2026

Gabon's state digital infrastructure holding SPIN signed a 20-year public-private partnership with Gabon Fiber S.A. in Libreville on 14 September 2026 to operate and extend the national fibre backbone to about 3,500km. Digital economy minister Mark-Alexandre Doumba said the concession is privately financed and returns the network, run by a foreign partner for over a decade, to Gabonese control.

- **Gabon Fiber : vers une connectivité plus étendue, plus performante et plus accessible** — GabonReview, 15 September 2026

  Gabon's digital infrastructure holding SPIN signed a 20-year public-private partnership with Gabon Fiber SA on 14 September 2026 to run, upgrade and extend the national fibre backbone from 16 November, when the Bouygues–Axione contract expires. SPIN keeps the existing 1,769 km, and Gabon Fiber will finance 1,651 km more, under an open-access obligation.

- **Télécommunications : MAGT et l'État signent une convention stratégique** — L'Union - Sonapresse, 7 October 2026

  Gabon's incumbent operator and the digital-economy ministry signed a convention at Mouila on 6 October ceding to the State the 196 km Fougamou-Mouila fibre section the operator pre-financed and built, with two technical centres. It is the first segment of the first phase of the national backbone extension.

CAB-CORRIDOR TERRESTRIAL INTERCONNECTION (CAMEROON, GABON, CONGO)

- **CAB-CORRIDOR : la SPIN et CAMTEL renforcent la connectivité numérique en Afrique centrale - Société de Patrimoine des Infrastructures Numériques CAB-CORRIDOR : SPIN et CAMTEL renforcent la connectivité en Afrique centrale** — SPIN Gabon, 3 October 2026 CAMEROON

  Gabon's digital infrastructure holding SPIN and Cameroon's operator CAMTEL have signed a memorandum of understanding and a confidentiality agreement on CAB-CORRIDOR, a terrestrial link between Cameroon, Gabon and the Republic of Congo over the Central African Backbone, SPIN said on 3 October 2026. Implementation terms are expected in October 2026; signing dates are not given.

Gambia

NINE-DIGIT MOBILE NUMBERING PLAN

- **The Gambia National Numbering Plan Migration Governance and Go-Live Framework, 2026** — Public Utilities Regulatory Authority (PURA), The Gambia, 3 September 2026

  The Gambia's Public Utilities Regulatory Authority adopted on 3 September 2026 a framework governing the switch of phone numbers from seven to nine digits under the National Numbering Plan 2026. It sets up a migration control centre within the regulator, eight readiness checks that default to no-go, and decision stages from go to rollback, with the final decision left to the Director General.

- **The Gambia National Numbering Plan, 2026** — Public Utilities Regulatory Authority (PURA), The Gambia, 3 September 2026

  The Gambia's Public Utilities Regulatory Authority adopted the National Numbering Plan, 2026 on 3 September 2026, effective the same day under the Information and Communications Act, 2009. It sets a nine-digit structure for numbers under country code +220 and brings short codes, emergency numbers and USSD codes under the regulator. A separate framework governs migration from seven-digit numbers.

- **Africell begins major numbering update** — The Standard, 4 September 2026

Africell Gambia's chief executive Hussein Diab Ghanem said on 4 September 2026 that the country's move to a new numbering system will raise national capacity to about 100 million numbers, with Africell subscribers getting the prefix 87. Old and new numbers will run in parallel at first, and an app feature will update saved contacts.

- **Gamcel to join the 9-digits migration in second phase** — The Standard, 7 September 2026

  Three Gambian operators moved to nine-digit mobile numbers at midnight, with the fourth to follow in a second phase on a reserved prefix, the regulator confirmed.

- **Gambia opens new chapter in digital growth with nine-digit numbering system** — The Point, 9 September 2026

  The Gambia's regulator PURA has moved telephone numbers from seven to nine digits, with old and new numbers running in parallel until the seven-digit format is retired on 28 February 2027. PURA worked with Meta and the ITU so systems abroad recognise the new format, and monitored Africell, QCell and Comium networks during the switch.

INTERNATIONAL CAPACITY ON THE ACE SUBMARINE CABLE

- **Profile – GAMTEL** — Gambia Telecommunications Company Limited (GAMTEL), 21 September 2026

  The Gambian state operator's undated company profile. It says Gamtel has four international gateways on the ACE submarine cable giving 25 Gbps, and a 28 Gbps backup link through Senegal's Free that traffic switches to if ACE fails.

Ghana

5G SPECTRUM REQUEST FOR APPLICATIONS

- **Ghana's NCA Receives Four Applications for 5G Spectrum Licences** — Tech Africa News, 2 September 2026

  Ghana's National Communications Authority closed applications for 700MHz, 2.3GHz and 3GHz mobile-broadband spectrum on 2 September with four applications received, and opened Envelope A under the published Selection and Award Procedure. Envelope B, holding the Best Price Offer, stays sealed. The authority was careful to say that opening Envelope A determines nothing about the eligibility, compliance or completeness of any application.

- **Ghana to begin 5G deployment by December 2026 – Sam George** — MyJoyOnline, 7 September 2026

  Ghana expects to complete 5G spectrum assignment and begin deployment by December 2026, its communications minister said.

- **MTN, Telecel, Goal Telecom qualify for next stage of NCA spectrum auction** — MyJoyOnline, 9 September 2026

  Ghana's National Communications Authority said on 9 September 2026 that MTN Ghana, Telecel Ghana and Goal Telecom qualified for the next stage of its licensing process for the 700 MHz, 2.3 GHz and 3 GHz bands. A fourth applicant, Infrava, was disqualified. The next stage opens and ranks the qualified applicants' price offers; no date is given.

- **UPDATE ON THE 5G SPECTRUM LICENSING PROCESS** — National Communications Authority (Ghana), 11 September 2026

Ghana's National Communications Authority concluded the 700 MHz stage of its 5G spectrum award on 11 September 2026, giving two lots to MTN Ghana, the only qualified applicant, for US$100.9 million. The 2.3 GHz band, sought by Telecel Ghana and Goal Telecommunications, is under-subscribed, and the 3 GHz band is over-subscribed; both go to the next stage.

- **5G licensing: MTN Ghana wins 700MHz spectrum for $100.9m** — Prime News Ghana, 12 September 2026

  Ghana's National Communications Authority assigned two 700 MHz lots, the most one applicant may win, to MTN Ghana for a licence fee of US$100.9 million. MTN was the only qualified bidder, which closes the 700 MHz stage of the 5G spectrum process; the 2.3 GHz and 3 GHz bands remain open.

- **NCA assigns 5G spectrum to MTN Ghana for US$109.9 million** — Graphic Online, 12 September 2026

  Ghana's National Communications Authority awarded two 700 MHz lots to MTN Ghana, the only qualified bidder, after opening best price offers on 11 September 2026. This account gives the fee as US$109.9 million; the regulator's release puts it at US$100.9 million.

- **Telecel Ghana gets NCA nod for 5G spectrum expansion** — Graphic Online, 16 September 2026

  Ghana's National Communications Authority awarded Telecel Ghana three lots in the 2.3 GHz band to support its 5G rollout, all the lots it applied for out of five on offer. The award is part of a competitive process covering the 700 MHz, 2.3 GHz and 3 GHz bands. Neither the assignment date nor the licence fee is stated.

- **NCA awards 5G spectrum to Telecel Ghana** — MyJoyOnline / Joy Business, 17 September 2026

  Ghana's regulator awarded the second operator all three of the 2.3 GHz lots it applied for, of five made available, a week after the dominant operator took both 700 MHz lots. No licence fee or assignment date is reported.

- **Scancom PLC (MTN Ghana) - MTN Ghana Receives Notice of Spectrum Award in the 700 MHz and 3 GHz Bands (GSE announcement, 2 October 2026)** — Scancom PLC (MTN Ghana), 2 October 2026

  MTN Ghana (Scancom PLC) told the Ghana Stock Exchange on 2 October 2026 that the National Communications Authority had notified it of 15-year spectrum awards: 2 x 20 MHz in the 700 MHz band for US$100.9 million and 150 MHz in the 3 GHz band for US$101.1 million. The company said it will use the spectrum for 5G once the licences are issued.

- **MTN set to deploy 5G services after winning spectrum licenses worth US$202m** — MyJoyOnline (Joy Business), 3 October 2026

  MTN Ghana says it will roll out 5G once the regulator issues the spectrum licences it has been awarded in the 700 MHz and 3 GHz bands, at a cost of about US$202 million. The company told investors the payments are already in its cash-flow outlook.

PPL NET GHANA SPECTRUM ALLOCATION AND CORE-NETWORK ACCESS

- **Sam George swears in AT Ghana's PPL Net board as directors vow 'We will not let Ghana down'** — MyJoyOnline, 3 September 2026

  Ghana's Communications Minister Sam George swore in a seven-member board for state-owned PPL Net Ghana, which runs the AT Ghana brand, on 3 September 2026. Cabinet has approved spectrum in three bands and access to GIFEC's core network, but both depend on the company filing audited accounts about a year in arrears; the minister said the regulator cannot legally issue spectrum without them.

CELL SITES NEEDED AGAINST SITES BEING BUILT

- **Ghana Needs 6,000 New Cell Sites To Improve Nationwide Connectivity – Minister** — The High Street Journal, 6 September 2026

  Ghana's communications minister, Samuel Nartey George, said on 6 September 2026 that the country needs about 6,000 new cell sites. About 1,100 are being rolled out, roughly 800 by MTN Ghana, of which nearly 180 are complete, and about 350 by Telecel, with completion expected in the first half of 2027. He also directed that all rural telephony sites be upgraded to at least 4G.

- **MTN commits US$1.1bn to Ghana network expansion after 5G reforms – Communications Minister** — MyJoyOnline, 7 September 2026

  The dominant Ghanaian operator's US$1.1bn three-year commitment is restated against the site build behind it: 800 new cell sites of which 180 are already active, and a second operator targeting 2,698 sites in 2026. The communications minister dates the regulator board's removal of wholesale 5G exclusivity to 15 July 2026.

AIRTELTIGO PROVISIONAL LICENCE AND SPECTRUM

- **Stranded Connectivity Equipments Relocated with Bets on Local-Language AI** — The High Street Journal, 7 September 2026

  Ghana's communications minister, Samuel Nartey George, said on 7 September 2026 that equipment from earlier rural connectivity projects, installed at sites with no line of sight or backhaul, is being relocated. He also said AirtelTigo has been given spectrum, a provisional licence and access to parts of the GIFEC core network after its own licences expired.

5G POPULATION COVERAGE TARGET FOR 2028

- **Ericsson and Ghana NCA Discuss 5G, Cybersecurity and Network Resilience** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026

  An Ericsson delegation called on Ghana's National Communications Authority to discuss 5G deployment, quality of service, cybersecurity and network resilience. The Authority's deputy director-general said 5G licence conditions require 70 per cent population coverage by March 2027 and that compliance monitoring would be strengthened.

CSQUARED OPEN-ACCESS FIBRE FEASIBILITY STUDY ON NEDCO LINES

- **USTDA Advances Secure Digital Access in Ghana** — U.S. Trade and Development Agency (USTDA), 9 September 2026

  The US Trade and Development Agency signed an agreement on 9 September to fund a feasibility study for open-access fibre laid along Northern Electricity Distribution Company lines, which span more than 60 per cent of Ghana. The study is to assess commercial viability, quantify demand and develop a financing strategy; no grant value is stated.

AMAZON LEO LOW-ORBIT BROADBAND COOPERATION

- **Ghana Discusses Amazon Leo Partnership for Broadband Expansion** — Ecofin Agency, 28 September 2026

  Ghana's president, John Dramani Mahama, discussed broadband cooperation with Amazon's chief global affairs officer, David Zapolsky, in New York on 25 September 2026, on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly. The talks focused on using Amazon Leo's planned constellation of more than 3,000 satellites to reach underserved communities. No agreement is reported.

TELECEL GHANA NETWORK MODERNISATION MEMORANDUM WITH HUAWEI

- **Telecel Group announces $200 million network modernization for Telecel Ghana** — TechFocus24, 6 October 2026

  Telecel Group signed a $200 million, three-year memorandum of understanding with Huawei Ghana at HUAWEI CONNECT 2026 in Shanghai to expand and modernise Telecel Ghana's network, including mobile broadband. It follows a $70 million agreement signed in Shenzhen the previous November. The signing date is not stated.

CELL-SITE BUILD FOR 2026

- **Ghana Plans 2,800 Telecom Site Builds and Upgrades Nationwide** — Tech Africa News, 16 October 2026

  Communications Minister Samuel Nartey George said Ghana will build 800 new cell sites and upgrade 2,000 more within the year across MTN and Telecel networks, with better coverage expected from late 2026 into early 2027. He also said more spectrum had been released in the past two years than in the previous two decades.

Guinea

INTERNET EXCHANGE POINT PARTICIPATION IN THE CONTINENTAL PEERING FORUM

- **AfPI 2026 : la Guinee renforce sa presence dans l'ecosysteme africain de l'interconnexion Internet** — Sahel Matin, 1 September 2026

  Guinea's internet exchange point, IXP-Guinée, attended the 15th African Peering and Interconnection Forum in Kigali on 17–20 August 2026, represented by its executive secretary Abdoulaye Sivory Sakho with backing from the digital economy ministry's WARDIP programme. Sessions covered exchange-point governance, network performance measurement, access to content delivery networks and peering.

WARDIP SUBMARINE-CABLE LANDING STATION

- **Gbessia : Sensibilisation des citoyens sur le projet WARDIP** — agpguinee.com, 16 October 2026

  A sensitisation session on WARDIP, the 2023-2028 West Africa regional digital integration programme, was held at Gbessia town hall on 16 October 2026 under Guinea's digital economy ministry. Participants were told that the submarine-cable landing station and cable laying may affect all 13 communes of Conakry and the prefectures of Coyah, Forécariah, Dubréka and Boffa, and what is planned to limit environmental and social harm.

Guinea-Bissau

STARLINK SATELLITE INTERNET SERVICE

- **COMUNICADO | ARN-TIC** — arn.gw, 17 September 2026

  Guinea-Bissau's ICT regulator, ARN-TIC, extended Starlink Guiné-Bissau's provisional authorisation to provide satellite internet until 31 December 2026, by Despacho 15/CA/ARN/2026 of 14 September, announced on 17 September. The regulator said the extension keeps the service running during the transition to a definitive general authorisation.

Kenya

DIGITAL SUPERHIGHWAY FIBRE AND HOTSPOT TARGETS

- **Govt steps up Digital Superhighway implementation** — People Daily, 4 September 2026

Kenya's principal secretaries for broadcasting and telecommunications, Stephen Isaboke, and for ICT and the digital economy, John Tanui, co-chaired a multi-agency meeting on 4 September 2026 to review the Digital Superhighway programme. The programme covers the national fibre network, last-mile connectivity, digital hubs and public Wi-Fi. No progress figures, costs or deadlines were given.

ALINET SOLAR-POWERED COMMUNITY NETWORK, SIPILI

- **Seeding change: A solar-powered community network shaping meaningful connectivity in Kenya** — Association for Progressive Communications (APC), 9 September 2026

  The Association for Progressive Communications reported on 9 September 2026 that the ALINET community network in Sipili, Kenya, run by the Arid Lands Information Network (ALIN East Africa), uses solar power as its main supply to withstand outages and voltage surges. ALIN obtained a licence for the network in 2023; Sipili's surrounding population is put at over 100,000, mostly farmers.

LULU COASTAL CABLE SYSTEM

- **Kenya coast gets first protected subsea cable, LuLu** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026

  A consortium unveiled the LuLu Coastal Cable System at ITW Africa 2026, presented as the first fully protected submarine cable dedicated to Kenya's Indian Ocean coastline: 500km linking five landing points from Mombasa to Lamu, including Vipingo Special Economic Zone, Kilifi and Malindi, pairing a seabed cable with a parallel protected terrestrial route. It is specified at 144 fibres and up to 60Tbps per fibre pair over a 25-year design life, with service targeted for the second quarter of 2028 subject to contract execution, and the Mombasa landing connecting it to cables already landed at the port. The co-developers named are INDOI of Mauritius, Blue Trade Investments as the Kenya-registered landing party, ARISE IIP, AfriTrade Consulting Group and Kingdom Bank; no project value or financing structure is stated.

- **New submarine cable puts Kenya's Coast on digital growth path** — The Standard, 10 September 2026

  A planned submarine cable would link Mombasa to Lamu through five landing points along Kenya's coastline, with a parallel terrestrial route to keep services running if the seabed link is disrupted. The developers say it will extend resilient connectivity along 500 kilometres of coast and support data centres, cloud services and technology businesses; the consortium is anchored on the Vipingo special economic zone.

PARATUS GOMA-TO-MOMBASA TERRESTRIAL FIBRE ROUTE

- **Paratus expands East Africa connectivity ahead of ITW Africa** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026 DRC RWANDA UGANDA

  Paratus said its 2,000km Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial fibre route is live and carrying traffic, announced at the ITW and Datacloud Africa conference in Nairobi. The route links eastern DRC to the Kenyan coast through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi, with access to subsea capacity landing at Mombasa. Starlink services have launched in Uganda alongside it, and the company is introducing a Layer 2 connectivity service over low-earth-orbit satellite for the East African market.

AIRTEL KENYA TELESONIC WHOLESALE FIBRE SUBSIDIARY

- **Airtel Africa Shuts Down Kenya Fiber Unit After Two Years** — Techweez, 14 September 2026

  Airtel Africa is winding up Airtel Kenya Telesonic, its wholesale fibre subsidiary, two years after launch, with a KES 16.1 million loss and no revenue in 2025. Its facilities licence was returned to the Communications Authority in February, with gazettement pending.

FRAMEWORK AGREEMENTS FOR NATIONAL BACKBONE AND CROSS-BORDER LINKS

- **Request for Bids KE-ICTA-538567-NC-RFB — Framework Agreements for Extending National Backbone and Cross Border Links (Lot 1, Lot 2)** — ICT Authority (Kenya), 15 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT Authority issued bidding documents on 15 September 2026 for three-year framework agreements to extend the national fibre backbone (Lot 1) and cross-border and metro links (Lot 2). The procurement falls under the Kenya Digital Economy Acceleration Project, financed by credits 7289-KE and 7290-KE, and bids are due on 29 October 2026. No contract value is given.

- **Kenya floats tender for national fibre backbone, cross-border links** — TechTrends Kenya, 16 September 2026

  Kenya's backbone tender will be scored 80% on technical factors and 20% on cost, with winning bidders required to disclose beneficial ownership. Public-sector fibre stood at 30,454km in 2026, up from 22,486km in 2022.

- **Kenya ICTA Opens Tender to Expand National Fibre and Cross-Border Connectivity** — Tech Africa News, 16 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT Authority opened an international tender to extend the national fibre backbone and cross-border and metro links under the World Bank-backed digital economy project, which TechAfricaNews says is financed by US$390 million in World Bank credits.

- **Kenya opens fibre backbone tender** — ITWeb Africa, 16 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT Authority tendered two framework agreements, national backbone links and cross-border and metro links, each for three years extendable by two. Treasury puts the public-sector fibre network at 30,454km against a 100,000km target before the 2027 election.

- **Kenya Allocates KSh 13 Billion to Expand Fibre Network by 27,000 Kilometres** — Tech Africa News, 13 October 2026

  Kenya will put KSh 13 billion into extending its national fibre backbone and cross-border links by at least 27,000 km, the ICT principal secretary told a pre-bid session. Gaps are to be allocated by reverse auction to draw matching private capital.

GUIDELINES FOR COMMERCIAL INTERNET TELEPHONY SERVICES

- **Kenya CA Moves to Finalise Guidelines for Commercial Internet Telephony Services** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  Kenya's Communications Authority invited stakeholders to validate its draft guidelines for commercial internet telephony services, after reviewing responses to an earlier consultation. The guidelines set the technical and operational terms for rolling out such services.

SATELLITE FREQUENCY LICENSING FRAMEWORK, 2026

- **Stakeholder Consultation on the Satellite Frequency Licensing Framework** — Communications Authority of Kenya, 13 October 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya published a draft Satellite Frequency Licensing Framework for comment on 13 October 2026, with submissions due by 6 November. It covers spectrum authorisation for satellite services from gateways to user terminals, makes landing rights a prerequisite, and would require type approval of equipment and records of every terminal and its location.

Lesotho

STARLINK SATELLITE INTERNET SERVICE

- **Vodacom Lesotho Launches Enterprise Satellite Connectivity Solution Powered by Starlink** — Space in Africa, 9 October 2026

  Vodacom Lesotho launched a managed satellite internet service for businesses and institutions built on Starlink, at an event in Maseru reported on 9 October 2026. It offers primary connectivity where there are no terrestrial networks, a backup option, and a combined satellite and terrestrial mode. Target sectors include financial services, health, education and public administration; no prices are given.

Libya

RETAIL MOBILE DATA TARIFFS

- **باقات إنترنت الهاتف المحمول** — شركة المدار الجديد (Almadar Aljadid), Libya, 3 September 2026

  A Libyan operator's live retail tariff card runs from 0.5 dinars for 50MB over one day to 80 dinars for 80GB over thirty. Libya publishes no regulated price basket, so operator cards are the only evidence of what data costs there.

SATELLITE BROADBAND OPERATOR MARKET ENTRY

- **Starlink's Libya Market Entry Remains on Hold as Negotiations Continue** — Space in Africa, 13 September 2026

  Talks between Starlink and Libya's General Authority for Communications and Informatics, open since 2024, had produced no agreement on licensing, spectrum or coverage as of 13 September 2026, according to regulator sources cited by Space in Africa. The regulator wants a local gateway in Libya, which Starlink has not accepted, though the company has agreed to set up a locally registered subsidiary.

NATIONAL EMERGENCY TELECOMMUNICATIONS PLAN (NETP)

- **هيئة الاتصالات تنظم ورشة عمل حول الخطة الوطنية للاتصالات في حالات الطوارئ** — The Libya Observer (Arabic), 28 September 2026

  Libya's telecoms authority and the ITU held a first two-day workshop in Tripoli to review the national emergency telecommunications plan, develop early-warning systems and a unified protocol, and set agencies' roles. The plan was conceived after communications with Derna and other eastern cities failed during Storm Daniel in 2023.

7,000 TELECOMMUNICATIONS TOWERS PROJECT

- **LPTIC Subsidiary Reviews Progress on 7,000 Telecom Towers Project** — Libya Herald, 3 October 2026

  Al-Bunya Investment and Services Company, a subsidiary of Libya's state telecoms holding company LPTIC, discussed its project for 7,000 telecommunications towers at its general assembly, reported on 3 October 2026. The company says the project aims to cut infrastructure operating costs, diversify revenue and use engineers from LPTIC's own companies. No progress figures, cost or timetable are given.

MEDUSA SUBMARINE CABLE

- **افتتاح مجموعة (أوزون) للاتصالات ببنغازي والإعلان عن وصول كابل (ميدوسا) البحري** — وكالة الأنباء الليبية (LANA), 18 October 2026

  Ozone (O3) Telecom Group opened in Benghazi and announced that the Medusa submarine cable has reached the city. It plans a 16,000 km fibre network, a Tier III data centre and a 5G trial by the end of 2026.

Madagascar

SATELLITE CONNECTIVITY FOR TEN ENCLAVED ZONES (DECIM)

- **Fifandraisan-davitra sy ny nomerika : tolotra maimaimpoana i Madagasikara** — Tia Tanindrazana, 8 September 2026

  Madagascar's digital development and telecoms ministry obtained 300 Starlink kits with free internet service under a cooperation with Starlink, reported on 8 September 2026, to connect remote areas. It follows free internet installed at the main public universities. No duration or cost of the free service is given.

UNIQUE MOBILE INTERNET PENETRATION

- **GSMA: Digital Reforms Could Connect 1.12 million More People in Madagascar and Add MGA 4.1 trillion to GDP by 2031** — GSMA, 16 October 2026 AFRICA

  A GSMA report launched in Antananarivo says four reforms could bring about 1.13 million more people in Madagascar onto mobile internet and add MGA 4.1 trillion to GDP by 2031: cheaper smartphones through lower levies and duties, a costed rural connectivity plan, lower sector taxes, and voice services in Malagasy. Unique mobile internet penetration was 14.3% in 2025. A companion GSMA report finds spectrum pricing and licensing reform across Africa could add more than US$120 billion to GDP between 2026 and 2035.

TAXES ON ENTRY SMARTPHONES AND MOBILE SERVICES

- **Obstacles à l'accès à internet - 47% du coût d'un smartphone sont constitués de taxes** — Midi Madagasikara (via allAfrica), 17 October 2026

  At the launch of a GSMA report on Madagascar's digital economy, operators said taxes make up 47% of the cost of an entry-level smartphone, including a 6% copyright duty. Mobile services also carry an 8% excise duty.

- **TECHNOLOGIE - Deux Malgaches sur dix connectés à Internet** — L'Express de Madagascar, 17 October 2026

  Only about two in ten people in Madagascar use the internet, although 3G and 4G networks cover more than 80% of the population. Operators blame the cost of handsets, and the 2026 finance law keeps the taxes on them.

Malawi

COMMUNICATION TOWER PROGRAMME

- **Malawi Activates 36th Rural Telecom Tower to Expand Digital Connectivity** — Tech Africa News, 3 September 2026

  The government switched on the 36th tower under the Last Mile Rural Connectivity Project, at Kalira Village in Traditional Authority Kalumbu.

- **Malawi drives next wave of connectivity** — ITWeb Africa, 3 September 2026

  The World Bank-financed programme carries US$150 million across digital connectivity, the universal service fund's 100-tower rollout, an e-services portal and the national data centre in Lilongwe. Its latest phase is expected to connect more than 500 public institutions and more than 2,000 schools.

DIGITAL MALAWI ACCELERATION PROJECT

- **World Bank turns heat on Malawi's digital transformation project** — Nyasa Times, 3 September 2026

  A World Bank mission reviewed the Digital Malawi Acceleration Project with the communications regulator MACRA. The project manager said a plan for 100 mobile towers in underserved areas has reached procurement preparation, and a consultancy is building the Data Protection Authority's framework and five-year cost model. The mission stressed the quality of MACRA statistics. No funding amounts are stated.

- **DMAP gains momentum as Government, World Bank reaffirm commitment to digital transformation** — Public Private Partnership Commission (PPPC), Malawi, 4 September 2026

  A World Bank mission team on the Digital Malawi Acceleration Project called on the ICT minister in Lilongwe, its task team leader saying the project anticipates funding for around 100 additional cell towers and connectivity for 500 government institutions, with biometric digital ID among key procurements. The minister said existing capacity of 12.5 Gbps is insufficient and called for at least 50 Gbps, a future-ready national data centre and integration of all ministries under the Bomalathu eService Portal.

- **Malawi Advances Next Phase Of Digital Connectivity** — Broadcast Media Africa, 4 September 2026

  Malawi plans to spend US$35m to US$75m on the second phase of the Digital Malawi Acceleration Project, part of a six-year programme with US$150m of World Bank financing. The phase aims to connect more than 500 public institutions, including the National Registration Bureau, and over 2,000 schools; the Public Private Partnership Commission discussed it with ICT providers in Blantyre.

- **IDEA Half-Year Implementation Progress Report: January-June 2026 and Outlook for July-December 2026** — COMESA Secretariat (IDEA project), 1 October 2026 ANGOLA DRC ZAMBIA ESWATINI EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  COMESA's half-year progress report on the World Bank-financed Inclusive Digitalisation in Eastern and Southern Africa programme, a US$2.48 billion envelope, covers January to June 2026 in Angola, the DRC, Malawi, Zambia and Eswatini. The COMESA secretariat had spent 9% of its US$3.71 million 2026 budget by June, and moved its AI and regional digital inclusion consultancies from procurement to implementation.

SCHOOLS WITH LIMITED OR NO INTERNET ACCESS

- **Msukuma calls for digitalization as Malawi schools struggle with connectivity** — 247MALAWI NEWS, 14 September 2026

  Education expert Zizwa Msukuma told 247 Malawi News that digitalisation should be a pillar of Malawi's education reform. He cited a 2026 school connectivity analysis finding that 85.8% of secondary schools lack internet access, 47% have no electricity, one computer serves 356 students on average, and 43% of school computers are in five urban districts.

INDEPENDENT TOWER COMPANY SITE ROLLOUT

- **Helios Towers Expands Rural Connectivity Push in Malawi With 55 New Sites** — Tech Africa News, 15 September 2026

  Helios Towers Malawi said it had built 233 tower sites in 2026, 40% in remote rural areas, with 55 more due by early October. The company gave the figures at a meeting with regulator MACRA, which pressed for lower-cost infrastructure in underserved areas.

HELIOS TOWERS AND UNICEF SCHOOL-CONNECTIVITY PARTNERSHIP (GIGA)

- **Helios Towers partners with UNICEF to accelerate digital inclusion and expand learning opportunities for children across Africa** — UNICEF UK, 28 September 2026 DRC TANZANIA

  Helios Towers and UNICEF announced a multi-year partnership on 28 September 2026 supporting UNICEF's Giga school-connectivity initiative and its Learning Passport digital-learning programme, starting in the Democratic Republic of Congo, Malawi and Tanzania. Helios Towers will support school connectivity mapping and infrastructure. No funding figure is given.

AIRTEL MALAWI CUSTOMER AND DATA BASE

- **Airtel Malawi Revenue Rises 33.8% as Currency Losses Hit Profit** — TechAfrica News, 29 September 2026

  Airtel Malawi's revenue rose 33.8% to K219.1bn in the half-year to June 2026, while exchange losses cut profit by more than half. Customers rose to 9.1 million, data customers to 2.9 million, and capital spending nearly tripled.

REGULATOR INVESTIGATION INTO MOBILE DATA DEPLETION

- **Airtel, TNM face Malawi data probe** — ITWeb Africa, 30 September 2026

  Malawi's regulator MACRA is investigating complaints of rapid data-bundle depletion on Airtel and TNM, examining their charging and billing systems. It had earlier found both operators applied approved tariff rises of 22.2% and 26% before the required seven-day notice.

- **Macra launches mobile data bundle consumption probe** — Nation Online, 1 October 2026

  The Malawi Communications Regulatory Authority opened an investigation, by notice dated 29 September 2026, into complaints that mobile data bundles on TNM and Airtel Malawi run out too fast. It will examine billing systems and usage records and run controlled tests of data used against data deducted, with a deadline of mid-November.

Mali

SENEGAL-MALI NATIONAL BACKBONE INTERCONNECTION

- **Bakel : inauguration de l'interconnexion des "backbones" du Sénégal et du Mali** — APS, 6 October 2026

  SENEGAL

  Senegal's and Mali's state fibre operators inaugurated the interconnection of their national backbones at the Kidira-Diboli border crossing on 5 October, to secure and diversify routes between the two countries. No capacity or cost is given.

Mauritania

SATELLITE BROADBAND LICENSING

- **أنترنت ستارلينك يطرق أبواب موريتانيا** — MauriNews (مورينيوز), 15 September 2026

  Mauritania appears on a satellite operator's list of sixteen African markets targeted for launch during 2026, after roughly two years seeking a licence. The authorities' conditions concern security guarantees and control over data, and an application lodged with a local partner is still pending.

MOBILE SERVICE QUALITY AGAINST LICENCE OBLIGATIONS

- **Contrôle de la qualité de service des opérateurs de communications électroniques : MATTEL sa, MAURITEL sa et CHINGUITEL sa — Période : du 13 février au 22 mars 2026** — Autorité de Régulation (ARE), Mauritanie — Direction Technique Télécoms et Poste, 7 October 2026

  Mauritania's regulator ARE published on 7 October 2026 its re-inspection of mobile service quality carried out from 13 February to 22 March 2026, finding that Mattel, Mauritel and Chinguitel still breach their licence obligations. Voice service failed in several towns and on major roads (Chinguitel on nine routes, Mattel on six), and mobile data fell below 3G thresholds in 14 localities for Mauritel and 12 for Chinguitel.

- **Mauritania's Digital Economy Plans Face Persistent Telecom Network Quality Problems** — Ecofin Agency, 9 October 2026

Mauritania's regulator ARE released results on 7 October 2026 of a February–March inspection that found failings in voice and mobile data services at Mattel, Mauritel and Chinguitel, including call completion and drop rates in several towns and on main roads and weak 3G and 4G performance. Ecofin sets this against the government's plans for online public services, AI and e-commerce.

Mauritius

MOBILE NUMBER PORTABILITY

- **Portabilité mobile : Garder son numéro en changeant d'opérateur** — L'Express (Maurice), 8 October 2026

  Mauritius' ICT Authority opened a call for applications for a new mobile number portability licence, announced at a three-day ICTA workshop in Balaclava reported on 8 October 2026. Chairman Tassarajen Pillay Chedumbrum said subscribers will be able to keep their number and SIM when changing operator. No launch date is given.

Mozambique

DATA-NETWORK INSTALLATION FOR HEALTH-CENTRE DIGITISATION

- **Pedido de Manifestacao de Interesse: Contratacao de 10 operadores para instalacao de infraestruturas de rede de dados para digitalizacao de 15 CS (CR58A000141/PS/No0025/FG/2026)** — Ministerio da Saude (MISAU), 2 September 2026

  Mozambique's health ministry is seeking ten operators to help its ICT staff install data networks at 15 health centres in Maputo city and province, under a Global Fund grant for 2024–2026. The work lasts three months at a daily rate of 600 meticais per operator, and expressions of interest close on 18 September 2026.

SALE OF PART OF THE STATE STAKE IN THE INCUMBENT OPERATOR

- **Manifestação de Interesse — Selecção de Parceiro Estratégico para a Moçambique Telecom, S.A. (Tmcel)** — Ministério das Finanças; Ministério das Comunicações e Transformação Digital (Mozambique), 12 September 2026

  Mozambique's finance ministry and communications ministry invited national and foreign bidders to express interest, within 15 days, in becoming strategic partner of the state telecoms operator Tmcel, possibly including a partial sale of the state's shares. The process was authorised by Government Resolution 67/2026 of 21 August; no amount is stated.

INCM TARIFF MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **Comunicado: INCM desenvolve sistema para maior transparência nas tarifas e pacotes de dados** — Instituto Nacional das Comunicações de Moçambique (INCM), 17 September 2026

  Mozambique's communications regulator, INCM, said on 17 September 2026 that it is developing a Tariff Management System, due to operate from November 2026, to monitor and compare operators' tariffs and data packages. The move follows consumer complaints that mobile data runs out too fast; the regulator is also restructuring telecoms packages.

- **INCM to Launch Internet Data Management System Amid Consumer Complaints** — 360 Mozambique, 18 September 2026

  Mozambique's telecoms regulator says a tariff management system due in November 2026 will compare operators' packages, identify the effective price including validity, and stop data bundles running out before their stated expiry, after consumer complaints. It is also restructuring packages.

STATE OPERATOR NETWORK AND CUSTOMER POSITION

- **Mozambique: Tmcel ends 2025 with 1.79 mln mobile customers, prepares for strategic partner** — Club of Mozambique, 17 September 2026

  Documentation prepared for the strategic partner the Mozambican government intends to bring into the state operator puts it at 1.79 million active mobile customers at the end of 2025, up 62.1 per cent on the year, on 1,303 sites and about 6,500 km of backbone with 4,500 km of access fibre. Fixed lines fell 20 per cent to 15,537; the figures are the seller's rather than a regulator's.

INTERNET PARA TODOS

- **Moçambique valida estratégia para acelerar acesso à Internet e inclusão digital** — Bureau de Conteúdo Local de Moçambique, 8 October 2026

  Mozambique's regulator is validating a proposed national 'Internet para Todos' strategy with operators, academia and civil society, with targets to 2030. Figures presented put internet access at about 20% of the population.

- **Mozambique targets 95% broadband coverage by 2030** — ITWeb Africa, 9 October 2026

  Mozambique's regulator validated its Internet for All strategy, which targets 95% broadband coverage by 2030, 12 million mobile internet subscribers and at least 60% of schools connected. It cited a programme to subsidise about 280,000 internet-enabled devices.

Namibia

QUARTERLY CONNECTIVITY USAGE

- **Cyber threats rise 57% despite ICT sector growth** — New Era, 18 September 2026

  Namibia's communications regulator reports cyber threat events up 57 per cent and vulnerabilities up 40 per cent in the April-June quarter, alongside 2 per cent growth in mobile subscriptions to about 2.79 million and about N$243m invested in networks.

LOW EARTH ORBIT SATELLITE BROADBAND SERVICE

- **Paratus Namibia launches Eutelsat's OneWeb LEO connectivity** — ITWeb Africa, 7 October 2026

  Paratus Namibia launched Eutelsat's OneWeb low-earth-orbit satellite internet service across Namibia on 7 October 2026, with capped and uncapped packages for homes and businesses. It follows a November 2025 agreement between Paratus and Eutelsat covering South Africa, Angola, Namibia, Botswana and Zambia. No prices are given.

Niger

OPERATOR PROMOTIONAL DATA TARIFFS

- **Avec 500F bénéficiez de 3.5Go de 23H à 06H pour naviguer en toute sérénité** — Moov Africa Niger, 1 September 2026

  Moov Africa Niger advertised a night-time mobile data bundle of 3.5GB for 500 CFA francs, usable from 23:00 to 06:00 and activated by dialling *1577#, in a LinkedIn post on 1 September 2026. That is about 143 CFA francs per gigabyte.

MOBILE NETWORK SERVICE QUALITY

- **L'air du temps : Le reseau mobile : mauvaise qualite et desarroi des usagers** — Le Sahel (ONEP), 4 September 2026

  Niger's electronic communications and post regulator launched a campaign on 27 July to verify mobile network coverage and the voice and data service map. A press account reports users facing poor quality for several months - interrupted calls, correspondents shown as unavailable or engaged - with the regulator's expert findings still awaited.

IN GUEZZAM TO ARLIT-AGADEZ FIBRE LINK WITH ALGERIA

- **Coopération Niger-Algérie : arrivée du ministre Hamani Kargné à Agadez pour le lancement des travaux d'interconnexion par fibre optique** — Ministère de la Communication et des Nouvelles Technologies de l'Information (Niger), 6 October 2026 ALGERIA

  Niger's communications ministry reported its minister's arrival at Agadez on 5 October with an Algerian delegation, describing the mission as the launch of fibre interconnection works between the two countries; the ceremony itself is summarised above.

- **L'Algérie et le Niger lancent l'exploitation de la dorsale transsaharienne à fibre optique** — Algérie Eco (reporting Algérie Presse Service), 6 October 2026 ALGERIA

  The Algerian account of the Assamaka ceremony, summarised above, says the link was built by Algerie Telecom and Niger Telecom, starts at 100 Gbps and can be expanded as traffic grows.

- **Niger-Algérie : lancement à Assamaka de l'exploitation de la dorsale transsaharienne à fibre optique** — Agence Nigérienne de Presse, 6 October 2026 ALGERIA

  Niger and Algeria launched operation of the fibre link between In Guezzam and the Arlit-Agadez region at a ceremony at Assamaka, on the border, on 6 October, chaired by the two communications ministers. Algeria's account gives a starting capacity of 100 Gbps.

Nigeria

AIRTEL NIGERIA RETAIL AND DISTRIBUTION NETWORK

- **Airtel Nigeria expands premium retail network** — ITWeb Africa, 1 September 2026

  Airtel Nigeria opened two premium experience centres in Lagos, taking its nationwide retail total past 350.

IFC FINANCING FOR AIRTEL AFRICA NETWORK UPGRADES

- **Airtel Africa Plans $1.1bn Investment as CEO Flags Power, Vandalism Challenges** — TechAfrica News, 1 September 2026

  Airtel Africa plans to invest about US$1.1 billion across its 14 African markets, its chief executive said, while naming power supply and infrastructure vandalism as the constraints on expanding coverage.

FLYX FIXED-WIRELESS ACCESS SERVICE

- **MTN Nigeria targets fibre gaps with FlyX** — ITWeb Africa, 2 September 2026

  MTN Nigeria launched FlyX, a 5G fixed-wireless home broadband service for locations where indoor reception is weak or its FibreX fibre product is unavailable, at ₦30,000 for 30 days at 50Mbps and ₦45,000 at 100Mbps, both unlimited. The operator holds a target of eight million Nigerian homes on fibre within three years and names lengthy approvals, the physical demands of cable installation and slow cost recovery as what stands in the way. Fixed wireless is the faster-to-deploy substitute rather than the plan.

LAGOS STATE UNIFIED FIBRE NETWORK

- **$80bn digital economy: Sanwo-Olu eyes Africa's innovation capital** — Vanguard, 2 September 2026

  Lagos State Governor Babajide Sanwo-Olu, represented by his deputy Obafemi Hamzat, told the GITEX Nigeria Official Tour on 2 September 2026 that the state has more than $80 billion in technology commitments. About 3,000km of a planned 6,000km fibre network was laid between 2019 and 2025, and the state plans to secure 200–400MW of state-procured electricity.

- **Hamzat tasks govt, businesses on technology-driven jobs, inclusive growth** — Realnews Magazine, 13 October 2026

  Lagos State's deputy governor said more than 6.4 million residents have enrolled in the state's resident identity system. He put state fibre at about 3,000 km, with a further US$22 million invested towards a 6,000 km network.

REVENUE PER SUBSCRIBER AT THE DOMINANT OPERATOR

- **MTN Nigeria is making more money but earning less from each customer** — TechCabal, 2 September 2026

  MTN Nigeria's average revenue per user fell 8.82% to $3.41 in the second quarter of 2026, its first decline since Q2 2025, even as first-half service revenue rose 25.9% to ₦2.99 trillion and subscribers grew 8.9% to 92.2 million. Naira ARPU also fell, 1.67% to ₦5,101, so the drop is not an exchange-rate artefact: 7.5 million subscribers were added in the half, against inflation of 15.91%, diluting the average. Nigeria supplied 30.64% of MTN Group's half-year revenue but ranks eighth of thirteen group markets on ARPU, against Ghana's $6.66.

UNIVERSAL COMMUNICATION ACCESS TOWER DEPLOYMENT

- **FG Set to Boost Telecoms Connectivity in Abia Rural Communities as Deputy Speaker Kalu Secures NUCAP Project for Bende** — ThisDay, 2 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications ministry named a federal constituency in Abia State a priority area under its universal communications access programme. A tower on the Umuahia–Ohafia road is nearing completion, and a preliminary assessment indicates five to eight further sites may be needed to cover the local government area.

- **Nigeria targets 200 telecom towers by December, plans new satellite beyond fibre coverage** — BusinessDay (Nigeria), 14 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications ministry said at least 200 towers for unconnected communities will be live by December, out of about 3,700 planned, with a new satellite for places neither towers nor fibre reach. The remarks came at the opening of the data protection commission's new Abuja headquarters, which reported 356 licensed compliance organisations.

- **FG to deploy 3,700 telecom towers to connect 20m Nigerians** — Vanguard, 16 October 2026

  Communications Minister Bosun Tijani commissioned the first tower of Nigeria's National Universal Communications Access Programme in Bende, Abia State, on 16 October 2026. The programme plans 3,700 towers to reach about 20 million Nigerians without phone or internet service, and the Deputy Speaker named 16 more Bende locations needing coverage.

9MOBILE NATIONAL ROAMING ON MTN

- **Glo's decline, T2's missing data widen MTN, Airtel's Internet lead** — TechCabal, 4 September 2026

Nigeria's telecoms regulator published three consecutive months of unchanged subscriber figures for T2 Mobile because the operator filed no reports, putting its base at 802,534 for April, May and June 2026 while its own porting data showed a net loss of 1,824 subscribers. Glo grew 7.8% between April and May then lost 7.3% in June, and the regulator recorded more than 5,000 fibre cuts nationally in the first half of 2026.

ACTIVE INTERNET SUBSCRIPTIONS AND DATA USAGE

- **Industry Statistics — Internet Subscriber Data and Internet Usage Statistics in Terabytes (monthly series to July 2026)** — Nigerian Communications Commission, 9 September 2026

  The Nigerian Communications Commission's monthly statistics, updated 9 September 2026, show 157,706,496 active internet subscriptions in July 2026, almost all on mobile, up from 138,749,365 a year earlier. Data usage in July 2026 was 1,662,021.45 terabytes, against 1,131,255.90 terabytes in July 2025.

- **Active Internet Subscribers Hit 157.7M as Internet Data Usage Increases to 1.7M Terabytes** — ThisDay, 17 September 2026

  Nigeria recorded 157,706,496 active data subscriptions and 1,662,021.45 terabytes of data usage in July 2026 on the regulator's own series — twelve consecutive months of growth from 140,328,196 subscriptions and 1,152,347.24 TB in August 2025, with a dip in June before recovery. The operators' association attributed the growth to stable regulatory policy and to a federal zero-rated educational access programme.

SUBSCRIBERS AT THE DOMINANT OPERATOR

- **MTN Nigeria becomes first telco to cross 100 million subscribers** — TechCabal, 9 September 2026

  MTN Nigeria became the first Nigerian operator to pass 100 million subscribers, ending July 2026 with 100.86 million on regulator data, up from 98.64 million in June and 51.76 per cent of the market. It spent NGN620.5 billion on capital expenditure excluding lease additions in the first half of 2026 on spectrum, fibre backhaul and other network infrastructure.

- **MTN Nigeria crosses 100 million subscribers** — ITWeb Africa, 10 September 2026

  A second account of the same milestone puts the operator's July gain at more than two million active subscriptions, from 98.64 million in June to 100.86 million, its strongest monthly rise of the year. Its chief executive has previously linked subscriber gains to stronger customer additions and rising data consumption.

FIXED BROADBAND SPEED AND TECHNOLOGY MIX

- **154 Million Consumers in Digital Dark Age as Infrastructure, Regulation Fail** — MyTimeNG, 13 September 2026

  Nigeria had 319,735 fibre-to-the-home connections at the end of June 2026 against more than 192 million active telephone subscribers, according to Nigerian Communications Commission figures. Operators added 12.8 million SIM cards and Nigerians used 10.2 million terabytes of data in the first seven months of 2026.

OPERATOR COVERAGE AND CAPACITY SITE COMMITMENTS

- **Telcos deploy 8,526 network sites despite fibre cuts — NCC** — The Punch, 13 September 2026

  Nigeria's mobile operators have deployed 8,526 of the 12,179 coverage and capacity sites they committed to, about 70%, up from about 5,000 at the previous count, the Nigerian Communications Commission said after its board meeting of 9 September 2026. The regulator said fibre cuts caused a sharp rise in network disruptions in June.

MOBILE VIRTUAL NETWORK OPERATOR LICENSING FRAMEWORK

- **Lebara launches Nigeria's second commercial mobile virtual network** — TechCabal, 14 September 2026

  Lebara Nigeria began commercial service as the second virtual network operator under the 2022 framework, after Vitel Wireless. It runs on Airtel's network under a 2023 licence and sells eSIMs with remote identity checks in its app.

NIGCOMSAT-2A AND 2B SATELLITES

- **Thales Alenia Space wins NIGCOMSAT contract to build NigComSat-2A geostationary telecommunications satellite** — Thales Alenia Space, 14 September 2026

  Thales Alenia Space signed a contract with Nigeria's NIGCOMSAT to build the NigComSat-2A geostationary satellite on a Spacebus B2 platform, with a service life above 15 years and coverage from West to Southern Africa. No contract value, financing or launch date is stated.

- **NIGCOMSAT Selects Hughes JUPITER Scalable Gateway to Support Nigeria's Next-Generation Satellite Program** — Hughes Network Systems, 16 September 2026

  Nigeria's state satellite operator NIGCOMSAT has chosen Hughes Network Systems' JUPITER gateway for the ground segment of its NIGCOMSAT-2A and 2B satellites, Hughes announced on 16 September 2026. Preparation begins in 2026 ahead of launches targeted for 2028 and 2029, and Hughes expects to advise on local assembly of satellite terminals. No contract value is given.

RURAL TELECOMS FACILITY UNDER THE DARES RENEWABLE-ENERGY ACCESS PROGRAMME

- **Hotspot secures World Bank facility for 500 communities** — Punch, 15 September 2026

  Nigerian rural infrastructure firm Hotspot Network secured a World Bank-backed results-based facility to bring 2G, 4G, broadband and community Wi-Fi to 500 unserved communities. The work sits under the US$750m DARES renewable-energy access programme run with the Rural Electrification Agency; the facility's amount and signing date are not reported.

TRANSFER OF UNUSED 5G SPECTRUM AND THE REVIEW OF UNDERUSED HOLDINGS

- **Mafab to give up its 5G spectrum as Nigeria starts a bigger clean-up** — TechCabal, 18 September 2026

  A Nigerian licensee is seeking to transfer its 2x20 MHz at 2.1 GHz and its 100 MHz block at 3.5 GHz to the largest operator, subject to regulatory approval. It paid US$273.6 million for the 3.5 GHz lot at the December 2021 auction against a US$197.4 million reserve, took a unified access licence in July 2022 and never reached commercial service; a wider review of underused spectrum is attributed to people familiar with the matter rather than to the regulator.

MONTHLY MOBILE DATA CONSUMPTION

- **Nigerians used 90% of 2025's internet data volume in eight months** — TechCabal, 13 October 2026

  Nigerians used 11.94 million terabytes of internet data in January to August 2026, about 90% of the whole of 2025, on the regulator's statistics. August alone took 1.76 million terabytes, with about 800,000 new internet subscriptions.

NIGERIAN NATIONAL BROADBAND PLAN 2020-2025

- **Nigeria expanded broadband but missed its 70% penetration target** — BusinessDay NG, 21 September 2026

Nigeria's National Broadband Plan 2020–2025 ended short of its main target: broadband penetration was 51.97% in December 2025 against 70%, according to NCC figures. 4G made up 52.95% of mobile subscriptions at the end of 2025, also short of its 70% target. The analysis traces penetration through the plan period, when it fell as low as 40.88% in 2021.

SATELLITE BACKHAUL PILOT ON NURAN-INFRATEL RURAL SITES

- **NuRAN Wireless to Pilot Starlink LEO Backhaul at Rural Site in Nigeria** — Tech Africa News, 24 September 2026

  NuRAN Wireless will pilot Starlink low-Earth-orbit satellite backhaul at a rural site in Nigeria with its partner Infratel, its first LEO integration, to test capacity, 4G migration and site costs. The satellite service is bought through third-party providers; NuRAN has no direct contract with Starlink or SpaceX.

PROJECT BRIDGE NATIONAL OPEN-ACCESS FIBRE

- **FG targets $1.2bn private funding for fibre project** — Punch Newspapers, 25 September 2026

  Nigeria's federal government is seeking about US$1.2bn in private capital for its planned 90,000km national fibre network, with physical rollout due from October 2026. Of the estimated US$2bn cost, US$800m is covered by World Bank, African Development Bank and EBRD loans, and a newly incorporated company is to carry out the project.

- **Nigeria Fast-Tracks Project BRIDGE to Connect 40 Million People** — TechSoma Africa, 25 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications minister Bosun Tijani said in New York on 22 September 2026 that Project BRIDGE, a 90,000 km national fibre build, will be delivered in three years rather than five, with cable laying from the fourth quarter of 2026 and completion by 2028 or early 2029. Development lenders have committed $845 million, including $500 million from the World Bank; the government will hold at most 49% of the project company.

- **FG, EU, EBRD sign €14m deal to drive 90,000-km fibre-optic backbone project** — BusinessDay Nigeria, 15 October 2026

  Nigeria, the European Union and the EBRD signed a EUR 14 million grant for the planned 90,000 km national fibre backbone, funded by the EU and managed by the bank. It pays for scoping, detailed network design, project preparation and capacity-building in the agencies implementing it.

DIGITAL CONNECTIVITY INVESTMENT FORUM COMMUNIQUE

- **NCC Seeks Greater Digital Infrastructure Investment at Nigeria Digital Connectivity Investment Forum** — Nigerian Communications Commission, 29 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications commission held its first Digital Connectivity Investment Forum in Abuja with Swedfund and Ookla, opening on 29 September 2026. Chief executive Aminu Maida called for more public and private investment in telecoms infrastructure to expand broadband and improve service quality. No investment commitments are reported.

- **NCC Issues Communiqué From Nigeria Digital Connectivity Investment Forum 2026** — Gentechnews, 4 October 2026

Nigeria's communications regulator issued the communique of its Digital Connectivity Investment Forum, held in Abuja on 29 and 30 September with Swedfund and Ookla. It sets actions on timelines of six to twenty-four months, among them open-access and wholesale regulation, a wholesale rate card, completed broadband mapping and a first national connectivity index report. It records broadband penetration at 57.4% against a 70% target.

STATE RIGHT-OF-WAY CHARGES FOR FIBRE

- **NCC hinges $1tr economy on telecoms, digital infrastructure** — The Guardian Nigeria, 30 September 2026

  At the Nigerian Communications Commission's Digital Connectivity Investment Forum in Abuja, officials and operators argued that broadband underpins the government's US$1 trillion economy target for 2030, and the regulator sought investors to close coverage gaps. Power costs and fragmented regional regulation were named as the main obstacles.

- **Why cheaper fibre fees fail to spark Nigerian infrastructure investment** — TechCabal, 19 October 2026

  A TechCabal analysis of Nigerian Communications Commission portal data from July 2026 finds that state right-of-way fees do not neatly predict where fibre has been built. Ogun charges up to ₦6,600 per metre yet has 4,246 km of fibre, while Jigawa and Zamfara, which waive the fee, have 970 km and 1,101 km. The piece notes that construction costs and other factors are not captured in the portal data.

INTERNET EXCHANGE POINT OF NIGERIA TRAFFIC

- **IXPN at 20: How Nigeria's Internet Exchange Point Has Transformed Local Internet Connectivity** — TechTV Network, 3 October 2026

  The Internet Exchange Point of Nigeria, founded in 2006, is marking its 20th anniversary with a month-long programme; it says more than 130 networks use it, with points of presence in Lagos data centres, Abuja and Enugu. The programme includes a visit scheme for about 100 students, an IPv6 training programme with AFRINIC and the Nigeria IPv6 Council, and an awards dinner in Lagos on 30 October 2026.

ACE CABLE LAGOS LANDING STATION

- **Dolphin Telecoms Signs 10-Year Solar Deal with Grid Crux to Power ACE Cable Landing Station in Lagos** — IDCNOVA, 13 October 2026

  UAE-based Dolphin Telecoms signed a ten-year energy-as-a-service deal with Nigerian developer Grid Crux Energy Solutions for a solar system at its Lagos landing station for the ACE submarine cable. Grid Crux will design, finance, install and run the system, expected to produce more than 144MWh a year and cut diesel use. No signing date or cost is given.

Rwanda

CROSS-BORDER TERRESTRIAL FIBRE ROUTE

- **Paratus expands East Africa connectivity ahead of ITW Africa** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026 DRC UGANDA KENYA

  Paratus said its 2,000km Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial fibre route is live and carrying traffic, announced at the ITW and Datacloud Africa conference in Nairobi. The route links eastern DRC to the Kenyan coast through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi, with access to subsea capacity landing at Mombasa. Starlink services have launched in Uganda alongside it, and the company is introducing a Layer 2 connectivity service over low-earth-orbit satellite for the East African market.

Sao Tome and Principe

INTERNET RESILIENCE INDEX SCORE

- **Internet Society Pulse: Sao Tome and Principe internet resilience** — Internet Society, 18 September 2026

  The Internet Society's resilience index scores São Tomé and Príncipe at 33 out of 100, below the Middle Africa average of 38 and the Africa average of 44, across infrastructure, market readiness, performance and security.

Senegal

HUBSIX INTERNET EXCHANGE POINT

- **IXP Tracker — HubSIX** — Internet Society Pulse, 1 September 2026

  The Internet Society's IXP tracker records HubSIX, an internet exchange point in Dakar, Senegal, with 260 Gbps of capacity and six member networks as of September 2026, all six having joined in the previous 12 months. The figures are self-declared in PeeringDB; no traffic volumes are given, and the exchange does not take part in the MANRS routing-security programme.

SENIX EXCHANGE POINT ASSOCIATION

- **Les Statuts — SENIX, Le Point d'Echange Internet du Sénégal** — Association SENIX, 3 September 2026

  The statutes of SENIX, Senegal's internet exchange point, constitute it as an association with its registered office at the telecommunications ministry in Dakar. Its stated purpose is to exchange local internet traffic directly, encouraging local services and reducing the cost of international bandwidth. The page is undated and names no members, traffic figures or operating site.

STARLINK FIXED SATELLITE INTERNET LICENCE

- **Internet par satellite : la Sonatel obtient la suspension provisoire de la licence de Starlink** — Le Soleil, 9 September 2026

  Senegal's Supreme Court on 7 September 2026 provisionally suspended the licence granted to Starlink Senegal for fixed satellite internet, on an application by the incumbent operator Sonatel. Sonatel is challenging ministerial order no. 038974 of 6 November 2025, which authorised the SpaceX subsidiary for five years, arguing that its own concession obligations and investments were not taken into account.

SCHOOL BROADBAND CONNECTION PLAN

- **Le numérique à l'école : 6 888 écoles et établissements à connecter à un internet haut débit** — Le Soleil, 26 September 2026

  Senegal's government plans to connect 6,888 schools to broadband internet, with satellite links for more than 2,000 others, it said at an interministerial council on the 2026–27 school year on 25 September 2026. Under the 2025–2029 education digital strategy, 6,547 tablets have been distributed and 12,385 teachers certified in digital skills and AI. No cost or timetable for the connections is given.

- **Sénégal : 6888 établissements scolaires ciblés par un vaste plan de connexion haut débit** — wearetech.africa, 28 September 2026

  Senegal plans to connect 6,888 schools to broadband, with satellite for more than 2,000 others, against education-ministry figures showing 19.7% of public elementary schools online in 2023 and 15.4% in rural areas. The plan sits under the 2025-2029 digital education strategy.

SENEGAL-MALI NATIONAL BACKBONE INTERCONNECTION

- **Bakel : inauguration de l'interconnexion des "backbones" du Sénégal et du Mali** — APS, 6 October 2026

  MALI

  Senegal's and Mali's state fibre operators inaugurated the interconnection of their national backbones at the Kidira-Diboli border crossing on 5 October, to secure and diversify routes between the two countries. No capacity or cost is given.

PASSANT TERRITORIAL DIGITAL-PLANNING PROJECT

- **Session parlementaire 2026-2027 : cinq propositions de commissions d'enquête à l'étude** — Le Soleil, 13 October 2026

  At the opening of Senegal's 2026–2027 parliamentary session on 13 October 2026, National Assembly president Ousmane Sonko announced five proposed commissions of inquiry. They include one on personal data in health under the health ministry's 13 March 2026 protocol with the United States, and one on Banco Santander-financed programmes, including the 50 billion FCFA PASSANT digital project. The proposals still need the Assembly bureau's approval.

Sierra Leone

GOVERNMENT WIDE AND LOCAL AREA NETWORKS (GWAN AND GLANS)

- **Procurement Review Panel Probes Alleged Irregularities in Digital Transformation Project** — Truth Media Sierra Leone, 21 September 2026

  Sierra Leone's Independent Procurement Review Panel opened an investigation into alleged irregularities in the Digital Transformation Project's contract for government network systems (GWAN and GLANS), after a complaint by Tiwai Memory Masters Ltd against the communications ministry. The panel said the outcome will be published once the review is complete. No contract value is given.

- **IPRP Vindicates MoCTI** — Black News, 8 October 2026

  Sierra Leone's procurement review panel dismissed a bidder's complaint over the evaluation of the World Bank-funded government network contract. It directed the ministry to open financial proposals and proceed to award.

Somalia

BERBERA INTERNATIONAL GATEWAY ROUTE

- **Somaliland fibre route tests Kenya's regional digital edge** — Business Daily, 15 September 2026 KENYA ETHIOPIA SOUTH SUDAN

  Berbera is being positioned as an alternative digital gateway for landlocked Ethiopia and South Sudan, offering providers, businesses and governments another route to global data connections beside the established Mombasa gateway.

NATIONAL INTERCONNECTION BETWEEN OPERATORS

- **Somalia's mobile money remains locked in silos** — ITWeb Africa, 5 October 2026

  The chief executive of Somalia's SomLink Telecom says voice calls now interconnect across six operators while mobile-money wallets remain closed to one another. He calls for cost-based pricing and shared rails, and says the largest operators have little commercial reason to open up.

South Africa

RÉUNION TO SOUTH AFRICA SUBMARINE CABLE

- **"RéuNION" : bientôt un nouveau câble sous-marin entre La Réunion et l'Afrique du Sud** — Outre-mer La 1ère (France Télévisions), 2 September 2026

  The Réunion regional authority launched RéuNION, a submarine cable from Saint-Paul to Durban costing €93.1 million and carrying 16 fibre pairs at 20 Tbps each. It is funded by €30m from the EU's regional development fund, €20m from the Connecting Europe Facility and €43.1m from the consortium, and must be built within three years under the European funding terms.

- **[vidéo] Un nouveau câble sous-marin en 2028** — Le Quotidien de La Réunion, 2 September 2026

  The Réunion to South Africa cable is scheduled to enter service in 2028, adding route diversity before an older system retires from 2027. Marine surveys run in 2026, with manufacture and laying to follow.

- **Free investit massivement dans un câble sous-marin pour sécuriser la connexion de La Réunion** — Univers Freebox, 2 September 2026

  A French operator set out its investment in the Réunion to South Africa cable, one of four consortium members behind a system carrying 16 fibre pairs at 20 Tbps each. The consortium is wholly French and about 79 per cent of the cost rests on public bodies.

- **Orange and Free to back La Reunion-South Africa subsea cable** — CNBC Africa (Reuters), 2 September 2026

  Two French operators will fund the €93 million cable between Réunion and South Africa, one acting as landing party and its marine subsidiary laying infrastructure designed by a French manufacturer. The cable is scheduled to enter service in 2028, replacing a system commissioned in 2002; the partners did not disclose their respective shares.

- **Free investit dans l'avenir numerique de La Reunion avec le projet de cable sous-marin ReuNION** — DCmag, 9 September 2026

  Free, through Telco OI, joined the EUR93 million ReuNION consortium led by La Reunion Connectee to build a submarine cable linking La Reunion directly to South Africa. The 16-fibre-pair system is planned for service in 2028 as successor to SAFE, in service since 2002 and at end of life.

DIGITAL CONNECTIVITY INVESTMENT ROADMAP TO 2035

- **South Africa's Digital Connectivity Investment Roadmap to 2035 (Digital Infrastructure Investment Study)** — Development Bank of Southern Africa (DBSA) / National Planning Commission (NPC), 30 March 2026

  A study by the DBSA and the National Planning Commission estimates that universal high-speed broadband in South Africa will need R108bn to R142bn of additional investment by 2035, in 2025 terms. An annex surveys the data-centre market, which it puts at nearly 500MW of potential IT load, concentrated in Gauteng.

THIRD NATIONAL FIBRE ROUTE, CAPE TOWN TO PRETORIA

- **Openserve completes third fibre route to reduce network outage risk** — BusinessDay South Africa, 7 September 2026

  The state-affiliated wholesale operator completed a third long-haul fibre route from Cape Town to Pretoria via Springbok and Mahikeng, built so the network stays up through major breaks. It sits inside a wholesale network of about 180,000km carrying just under R3bn of capital expenditure a year.

STATE SIGNAL DISTRIBUTOR FINANCIAL POSITION

- **Sentech trims losses but remains in the red** — ITWeb South Africa, 10 September 2026

  South Africa's state signal distributor cut its net loss after tax to R60 million in 2025/26 from R246 million, an improvement of about 76 per cent, and reported a clean audit with no material findings. The previous year's loss was driven mainly by a provision for expected credit loss reflecting customers' economic difficulties.

EQUINIX CAPE TOWN LAND USE

- **Activists appeal Cape Town data centre approval** — GroundUp, 14 September 2026

  The Housing Assembly and Foxglove, represented by the Legal Resources Centre, appealed the City of Cape Town's 14 July rezoning approval for an Equinix hyperscale data centre at King Air Industria, GroundUp reported on 14 September 2026. They say nearby communities were not consulted and that the application lacked information on water, electricity, emissions and noise for the proposed 174 MVA facility. Equinix has not yet submitted a site plan.

- **Cape Town to write new rules for big data centre applications** — TechCentral, 17 September 2026

  Cape Town is drafting new development guidelines for large data-centre applications, its first public acknowledgement that the approvals process needs changing, and confirms that the hyperscale precinct rezoning it granted in July is suspended pending appeal. The operator named throughout the project says the site is a long-term land bank on which it has submitted no planning application.

- **Big Tech or public good? What Cape Town's data centre battle means for residents** — Daily Maverick, 12 October 2026

  One of the organisations appealing against land-use rights for a planned hyperscale data centre in Cape Town argues that the mayor should uphold the appeal because the application did not state the site's water use, emissions or jobs. It writes that the appeal went before the city's advisory panel on 12 October and that the mayor then has 90 days to decide.

SUSTAINABLE CONNECTIVITY AND COMMUNITY-LED DIGITAL ECONOMIES IN SOUTH AFRICA PROJECT

- **WOAN comeback in KZN with R7m UK funding** — ITWeb South Africa, 15 September 2026

  A R7m UK-funded programme in KwaZulu-Natal, run with South Africa's communications department, will support 25 local community network operators to deploy 250 public Wi-Fi hotspots, connect 150 schools, libraries and clinics and reach 1,500 homes. It applies the shared wireless open-access model locally after the national version was put on hold; no term or completion date is given.

GAUTENG SMART SCHOOLS PROGRAMME

- **Gauteng Legislature visits facilities on SMART Schools Programme** — Gauteng Provincial Legislature (gov.za), 16 September 2026

  The Gauteng Provincial Legislature's e-Government and Research Development committee, chaired by Mbali Hlophe, announced oversight visits to schools under the province's SMART Schools Programme from 17 September 2026, starting at Moshate Secondary in Sedibeng and Johannesburg School. It will examine network reliability, delays in ICT infrastructure, incomplete connectivity, underfunding and reliance on temporary connections.

POLICY DIRECTION RESERVING HIGH-DEMAND SPECTRUM FOR A WIRELESS OPEN ACCESS NETWORK (2019)

- **Wireless open access network licensing direction withdrawn** — ITWeb South Africa, 28 September 2026

South Africa withdrew the 2019 policy reserving high-demand spectrum for a wireless open access network that was never licensed, freeing it for the regulator to assign. Wholesale, universal-service and anti-concentration obligations on licensees stay, as does the 2024 set-aside for the state digital infrastructure company.

MTN ACQUISITION OF IHS HOLDING

- **South Africa's Competition Commission Backs MTN's IHS Tower Deal, With Conditions** — TechAfrica News, 30 September 2026

  Trade-press account of the Competition Commission's conditional recommendation on MTN's purchase of IHS, summarised under the Commission's own statement.

- **Statement on the Latest Decisions by the Competition Commission** — Competition Commission South Africa, 30 September 2026

  South Africa's Competition Commission recommended that the Tribunal approve MTN's acquisition of tower operator IHS, on conditions of fair and non-discriminatory access to IHS towers for rival operators, fair lease renewals, ring-fencing of customer information and an operationally independent IHS. Job protection and ownership conditions are attached.

VODACOM WESTERN CAPE NETWORK INVESTMENT

- **Vodacom Western Cape Invests R500 Million to Expand 5G and Digital Connectivity** — Tech Africa News, 6 October 2026

  Vodacom says it is investing more than R500 million in its Western Cape network this financial year. About R380 million goes to modernising the radio network at more than 50 sites, with 4G capacity upgrades, new 5G sites and backup power in townships including Khayelitsha, Delft and Mitchells Plain.

LEO SATELLITE LICENSING FRAMEWORK

- **Regulators must know when not to regulate – ICASA chairperson** — Connecting Africa, 8 October 2026

  ICASA's chairperson said the regulator has developed a draft satellite licensing framework and will use sandboxes and lighter-touch approaches beside licensing. He named data centres and cloud computing as infrastructure it must now address.

SATELLITE MARKET ENTRY VIA SECTION 13

- **Starlink rival maps out SA strategy beyond satellite broadband** — ITWeb South Africa, 8 October 2026

  Amazon Leo said it has applied for licences to bring a direct-to-device satellite service to South Africa with mobile operators, probably from around 2028. Its fixed satellite broadband is to be distributed by Herotel from 2027.

GOVERNMENT NETWORK SITE SPEEDS

- **South Africa Wants a Digital Government. Some Government Offices Still Have Copper Internet. | Apples and Oranges** — Apples and Oranges, 11 October 2026

  South Africa's Auditor-General found that 2,076 of about 7,800 sites on the state IT agency's network ran below 10Mbps and that 294 government facilities were still on copper, in its audit of the communications department for 2025/26. The state broadband programme also fell short of its target of 14,742 sites for the year.

UPPER 6GHZ 5G-ADVANCED TRIAL

- **MTN SA trials Africa's first 5G-U6GHz network** — ITWeb Africa, 13 October 2026

  MTN South Africa said it had completed a 5G-Advanced trial in the upper 6GHz band at its headquarters, under a temporary licence, reaching peak downloads of 10.35 gigabits a second. The regulator's 2026 frequency plan allocates the band to mobile, but it is not yet licensed commercially.

PUBLIC SERVICE INSTITUTIONS CONNECTED UNDER THE 2022 SPECTRUM-LICENCE OBLIGATIONS

- **Media Statement: Committee Concerned as Public Service Institution Connectivity Reaches Only 49.1% of Spectrum Obligation Target** — Parliament of South Africa, 14 October 2026

  South Africa's mobile operators had connected 10,851 of the 21,878 public service institutions required under their 2022 spectrum licence obligations, 49.1%, by March 2026, the regulator ICASA told Parliament's communications committee on 14 October 2026. Vodacom, Telkom and Liquid met the 65% minimum threshold; MTN and Rain did not.

South Sudan

MOBILE COVERAGE GAP IN RURAL COUNTIES

- **SPLM calls for expansion of telecommunication coverage in Lafon County** — One Citizen Daily Newspaper, 3 September 2026

  South Sudan's SPLM called on the National Communication Authority and mobile operators to extend coverage across Lafon County and other rural areas. A community delegation from Eastern Equatoria said news of an attack on 26 August took up to four days to reach state authorities because messengers had to walk to find a signal.

NATIONAL FIBRE BACKBONE PROGRAMME (2,400 KM VIA KENYA)

- **Specific Procurement Notice — Request for Bids, Capex for Fibre Deployment for Route A-B (RFB No. SS-MICT&PS-544330-NC-RFB)** — Ministry of Information, Communication Technology and Postal Services (South Sudan), Project Implementation Unit, 10 September 2026

  South Sudan's ICT ministry invited bids on 10 September 2026 to design, supply and operate a fibre backbone on Route A-B, financed under the World Bank-funded Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project (grant E1780). Payments will be made directly by the World Bank.

- **South Sudan's Fibre Push Is Moving From Promise to Procurement** — South Sudan Press, 14 September 2026

  South Sudan's ICT ministry has invited international bids for about 397km of terrestrial fibre on the Juba–Nadapal route towards the Kenyan border, financed by World Bank grant E1780 under the Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project. Bids close on 26 October 2026. The backbone is to have at least 17 points of presence; no contract value is stated.

Sudan

HORIZON FIBER INITIATIVE (DJIBOUTI-ETHIOPIA-SUDAN CORRIDOR)

- **Projet de fibre optique « Horizon » : Une nouvelle autoroute numérique pour la Corne de l'Afrique** — La Nation, 9 September 2026 DJIBOUTI ETHIOPIA

  Djibouti Telecom, Ethio telecom and Sudatel presented their Horizon terrestrial fibre project to Google, Meta, Microsoft, Amazon and other carriers and vendors in Addis Ababa on 7 September 2026. The multi-terabit link would connect cable landing stations in Djibouti and Port Sudan through Ethiopia, reducing reliance on Red Sea submarine cables. No cost or launch date is given.

Tanzania

758-TOWER RURAL CONNECTIVITY PROJECT

- **Tanzania tells WTPF session how its citizens enjoy access to inclusive, secure communication services** — Daily News Tanzania, 4 September 2026

  Tanzania set out three ICT priorities at the ITU's seventh World Telecommunication/ICT Policy Forum in Nassau: expanding affordable access, strengthening digital skills and AI use across social groups, and building secure and inclusive infrastructure that protects personal data. The communications minister said the country had completed 758 4G towers reaching more than 1,400 villages and about 8.5 million people, established 800 digital clubs, provided Wi-Fi at 100 public locations and computer laboratories in 250 public schools.

KIGOMA-KALEMIE FIBRE ACROSS LAKE TANGANYIKA

- **Tanzania, DRC agree to fast-track SGR link and fibre-optic cable across Lake Tanganyika** — Daily News (Tanzania), 5 September 2026 DRC

  Tanzania and the DRC agreed to fast-track a fibre-optic cable from Kigoma to Kalemie across Lake Tanganyika, alongside a standard gauge railway link through Burundi and the establishment of a joint economic commission. The commitment was reaffirmed at a farewell meeting for the Congolese ambassador; no route survey, cost, financing or delivery date is published.

OPERATOR QUALITY OF SERVICE

- **TTCL Tops Tanzania Telecom Quality Rankings Despite Small Market Share** — Tech Africa News, 7 September 2026

  The state operator scored highest on the regulator’s quality measurement for the quarter to June 2026, at 98.1 per cent against 97.7 and 97.1 for the two larger operators.

NATIONAL ICT BROADBAND BACKBONE

- **TTCL and BBS Increase Tanzania-Burundi Connectivity Capacity from 4Gbps to 10Gbps** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026 BURUNDI

  Tanzania's state operator agreed with Burundi Backbone System to raise cross-border capacity from 4Gbps to 10Gbps through the National ICT Broadband Backbone, framed as a response to demand for cross-border digital services and enterprise connectivity.

TOWER ESTATE OF THE LARGEST INDEPENDENT TOWER OPERATOR

- **Serikali: Uchumi wa kidijitali unahitaji uwekezaji zaidi** — Mwananchi, 10 September 2026

  Tanzania's digital economy needs more investment, the deputy communications minister said at a tower company's fifteenth anniversary event in Dar es Salaam. The operator is targeting 4,500 sites in the country by the end of 2026, against more than 4,000 now.

INTERNATIONAL INTERNET CAPACITY AND USE

- **Robust policies, plans and collaboration drive Tanzania's communications sector** — The Citizen, 25 September 2026

  Tanzania's regulator TCRA reported that mobile-network fraud reports fell 69% between September 2023 and June 2026, from 23,328 to 7,334 cases. Mobile money accounts rose from 32.7 million in March 2021 to 87.0 million in June 2026, and only 15.4% of the country's 17,690 Gbps of international capacity was in use.

INTERNET EXCHANGE POINTS

- **TIX upgrades core to 100G as Tanzanian traffic jumps 80%** — tech.africa, 25 September 2026

  The Tanzania Internet eXchange in Dar es Salaam upgraded its core switching to 100G, the ISP association TISPA said on 23 September. On the exchange's own statistics its 66 connected networks averaged about 205 Gbps in late September 2026, up from about 110 Gbps a year earlier.

HELIOS TOWERS AND UNICEF SCHOOL-CONNECTIVITY PARTNERSHIP (GIGA)

- **Helios Towers partners with UNICEF to accelerate digital inclusion and expand learning opportunities for children across Africa** — UNICEF UK, 28 September 2026 DRC MALAWI

  Helios Towers and UNICEF announced a multi-year partnership on 28 September 2026 supporting UNICEF's Giga school-connectivity initiative and its Learning Passport digital-learning programme, starting in the Democratic Republic of Congo, Malawi and Tanzania. Helios Towers will support school connectivity mapping and infrastructure. No funding figure is given.

REGULATOR'S DIRECTIVE ON NETWORK-INFRASTRUCTURE FAULTS AND NEW FIBRE INSTALLATIONS

- **Tanzania's TCRA Gives Telecom Providers 30 Days to Fix Infrastructure Faults** — Tech Africa News, 14 October 2026

  Tanzania's TCRA gave telecoms providers 30 days to correct faults found in inspections, among them unsafe cabling, damaged poles and unmarked infrastructure. Some providers must file full GIS maps of their networks, and new fibre installations now need the Authority's prior approval.

Tunisia

TUNIXP NATIONAL INTERNET EXCHANGE POINT

- **À propos – ATI Tunisie Internet** — Agence Tunisienne d'Internet (ATI / Tunisie Internet), 3 September 2026

  The Tunisian Internet Agency (ATI) describes itself as Tunisia's incumbent internet operator since 1996, now an access provider and national host. Its own page says it runs the national internet exchange point (TUNIXP), the .tn and .تونس domain registry and national IP addressing. The page carries no date.

Uganda

SMARTPHONES IN USE

- **UCC launches study on smartphone usage as Uganda targets universal coverage by 2030** — The Independent / URN, 1 September 2026

  Uganda's communications regulator launched a study of smartphone penetration, device cost and usage, against a stated target of full national network coverage by 2030.

STARLINK OPERATIONAL LICENCE

- **Govt welcomes Starlink internet service provider** — New Vision, 2 September 2026

  Starlink began commercial service in Uganda, ending the regulatory process that followed a memorandum and a five-year operating licence signed with the communications regulator in May 2026. The licence requires a national gateway and physical point of presence, an operational office, and registration of every device activated in the country.

- **Starlink goes live in Uganda; price comparisons against MTN, Airtel** — Pulse Uganda, 2 September 2026

Prices published with the Ugandan launch put a residential 100 Mbps package at Shs203,704 a month against an estimated Shs2.3 million to start, plus a Shs437,036 regulatory charge — against fibre offers from the two mobile incumbents advertised at Shs110,000 and Shs99,000 for the same speed.

UGANDA-TANZANIA FIBRE ROUTE ON THE TRANSMISSION NETWORK

- **UETCL in Spotlight Over Uganda-Tanzania Fibre Connection** — Nile Post, 4 September 2026

  Uganda's parliamentary committee on state enterprises questioned the Uganda Electricity Transmission Company (UETCL) over the cancellation of open bidding for a partner to commercialise its fibre network. The energy ministry directed the termination in 2026 and Samanga Utilities was then considered for a Uganda–Tanzania fibre link, following a presidential directive of August 2025 seeking cheaper internet routes than those through Kenya.

PARATUS GOMA-MOMBASA ROUTE

- **Paratus expands East Africa connectivity ahead of ITW Africa** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026 DRC RWANDA KENYA

  Paratus said its 2,000km Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial fibre route is live and carrying traffic, announced at the ITW and Datacloud Africa conference in Nairobi. The route links eastern DRC to the Kenyan coast through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi, with access to subsea capacity landing at Mombasa. Starlink services have launched in Uganda alongside it, and the company is introducing a Layer 2 connectivity service over low-earth-orbit satellite for the East African market.

AIRTEL SATELLITE-TO-MOBILE SERVICE WITH STARLINK

- **Airtel Uganda Rolls Out Starlink Satellite-to-Mobile Service** — Tech Africa News, 24 September 2026

  Airtel Uganda launched Starlink satellite-to-mobile service, giving compatible smartphones SMS and light data such as WhatsApp outside terrestrial coverage, free for a 30-day trial and then through data bundles. Uganda is Airtel Africa's second commercial market for the service after the DRC in August.

UGANDA TELECOM REVIVAL AGREEMENT

- **Museveni Orders Cancellation of UTel Deal, Calls Investors 'Bafere' Over Missing $25 Million** — Nile Post, 9 October 2026

  Uganda's President Yoweri Museveni ordered the cancellation of the government's agreement with Rowad Capital Commercial to revive Uganda Telecom at a State House meeting on 6 October 2026, according to unnamed meeting sources. The investor had not paid the initial US$25 million of a US$225 million package in four years. Ministries are to prepare a Cabinet paper on state funding for the revival.

Zambia

MOBILE AND MOBILE INTERNET SUBSCRIPTIONS

- **Giving business and citizens a smart edge** — Freight News, 3 September 2026

  A Freight News feature on Zambia's National Digital Strategy 2023–27 quotes the World Bank's Paul Ndungutse on ZamPortal services such as road fitness certificates, immigration and land services. Citing an April 2026 Presidential Delivery Unit statement, it reports 95% mobile population coverage and internet subscriptions rising from 10.4 million in 2021 to 14.7 million in 2025.

- **Govt seeks Tech partnerships to build local capacity** — Lusaka Times, 18 September 2026

> Zambia's Ministry of Technology and Science told a visiting Hikvision delegation that technology partnerships must include skills transfer, local value retention and compliance with Zambian law. It said internet subscriptions rose from 10.4 million to 14.68 million between 2021 and 2025, fibre coverage grew from about 15,000 to over 42,000 km, and mobile money transactions rose from K169 billion in 2021 to K486 billion in 2024.

> AIRTEL ZAMBIA ACQUISITION OF AIRTEL TELESONIC FIBRE NETWORK

- **Airtel invests K324m in 1,300km optic fibre network** — Zambian Business Times, 21 September 2026

  Airtel Zambia is acquiring about 1,300 km of fibre-optic infrastructure from its related company Airtel Telesonic Zambia for K324.9 million, the Zambian Business Times reported on 21 September 2026. The deal is classed as a small related-party transaction, equal to 1.40% of Airtel Zambia's market value.

Zimbabwe

> RETIREMENT OF THE 3G NETWORK

- **Econet says to phase out 3G by end of 2027** — NewsDay, 10 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's largest operator will shut down its 3G network by the end of December 2027, its chief executive said, retiring 3G before 2G because 2G remains widely used in rural areas by subscribers with basic feature phones. The operator is accelerating investment in 4G and 5G.

> ECONET INFRACO

- **Econet InfraCo - Unaudited Abridged Interim Financial Statements for the Half Year Ended 31 August 2026** — Econet Infrastructure Company Limited, 1 October 2026

  Econet InfraCo, the tower, power and property arm of Econet Wireless Zimbabwe listed on the Victoria Falls Stock Exchange, reported unaudited revenue of US$70.1 million and profit of US$13.7 million for the six months to 31 August 2026, with no interim dividend. It said solar power and AI-based fuel management cut fuel use by 30%, and construction began on a planned 100MW solar farm.

- **Econet InfraCo reports solid maiden half-year results after VFEX listing** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 4 October 2026

  Econet InfraCo, the tower, power and property company listed in Victoria Falls, reported revenue of US$70.1 million and EBITDA of US$29.0 million for the six months to 31 August 2026, its first half-year results since listing.

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